Balance in Inequality: Testing the Physical Equilibrium, Precession, and Structural Stability of Magic Gems

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Abstract

A magic square is a combinatorial paradigm of *balance in inequality*: its n^2 entries $\{1,\dots,n^2\}$ are strictly unequal, yet every row, column, and main diagonal sums to the same constant $\mu_n = n(n^2+1)/2$. Lifting the centred grid cells into $\mathbb{R}^3$ as radial vectors $\mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda) = (x_j, y_i, \lambda z_{ij})$ and taking their convex hull—the *Magic Gem* $\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S)$—raises a central mechanical hypothesis: *when does combinatorial line-sum balance suffice for physical equilibrium in three dimensions, and when a nonlinear physical realization breaks that balance, how can an opposing inequality restore it?* We test this hypothesis across all 880 order-four magic squares through four progressive mechanical regimes, moving from one-dimensional rays to three-dimensional rotation, solid and skeletal hulls, and freestanding stacked towers. **Test 1 (Radial rays from the origin):** Natural spoke vectors $\mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda)$ balance identically at the origin O, whereas trimming the spokes to equal unit length breaks equilibrium on all 832 non-associative squares in 3D and on *every* square in 2D, where the irrational ring-radius ratio $r_2/r_1 = \sqrt{5}$ bounds the resultant below by the Pell convergent $9/4 \approx \sqrt{5}$ ($18\sqrt{10}/5 - 8\sqrt{2} \approx 0.0705$). By *length–weight duality*, equilibrium is restored by playing unequal weights against equal lengths (positive minimum-variance weights $\mathbf{w}^* > \mathbf{0}$ on S^2 for all 880 squares) or by power-law spoke scaling (r^{α^*} in 2D and cubic vertical vanishing $(\mathbf{V}_3)_z = 0$ in 3D). **Test 2 (Three-dimensional rotation):** Equal point masses at the unequal vertices $\mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda)$ make every semi-magic square an axisymmetric rotor with universal inertia ratio $I_\perp(\lambda)/I_{zz} = \frac{1}{2}(1+\lambda^2(n^2+1))$ and spherical-top scale $\lambda_{\text{iso}} = (n^2+1)^{-1/2}$. Conversely, weighting the vertices by their unequal entries $m_{ij} = s_{ij}$ exposes the quadrant quadrupole $Q_{xy} = \sum z_{ij}x_jy_i$, splitting the horizontal principal moments by $2|Q_{xy}|$ and triggering 180° Dzhanibekov flips on 824 squares. **Test 3 (Convex solids, skeletons, and shells):** Wrapping P_S in its uniform solid hull $\mathcal{G}_0(S)$ breaks centroid balance on 829 squares by discarding interior grid points $P_S^{(1)}$ and weighting facets by unequal simplex volumes. Because the outer hull vertices and inner core points pull in strictly opposite directions ($V_0\overline{\mathbf{p}}_{\text{outer}} + V_1\overline{\mathbf{p}}_{\text{inner}} = \mathbf{0}$), re-engaging the inner core $\mathcal{G}_1(S) = \operatorname{conv} P_S^{(1)}$ restores $\mathbf{c} = \mathbf{0}$ via two-density core inclusions, two-gauge nested wireframes, or the complete $\binom{n^2}{2}$-rod network K_{n^2} ($\Sigma_{\text{rods}} = \frac{2n^2-3}{3(n^2-1)}\Sigma(\lambda)$), while every boundary hull unfolds into a non-overlapping papercraft net with $f_0 - 1$ glue tabs. **Test 4 (Gravity and vertical stacking):** Compressing the vertical scale to the cubic print aspect $\lambda = 1/5$ stabilizes 74.5% of all gem facets on a flat table, and alternating any gem $\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S)$ with its inverted mirror twin $\mathcal{G}_\lambda(r^2\overline{S}) = -\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S)$ cancels opposing facet tilts to lock chiral blocks into a straight vertical tower.

1 Introduction: Balance in Inequality

Over five centuries ago, Albrecht Dürer contributed two enduring landmarks at the intersection of mathematics and the visual arts: the order-four magic square in his 1514 engraving *Melencolia I* (square #175 in Frénicle's 1693 census of the 880 order-four magic squares [8, 6, 1]) and the first printed polyhedral net unfoldings in his 1525 treatise *Underweysung der Messung* [7, 18, 5, 9]. A magic square is a quintessential study in *balance in inequality*: an arrangement $S = (s_{ij})_{0\le i,j<n}$

of the first $N = n^2$ positive integers $\{1, \dots, N\}$ in which no two cells are equal, yet every row, column, and main diagonal sums to the exact same magic constant $\mu_n = n(N+1)/2$ (a *semi-magic square* if the row and column sums equal μ_n). Measuring coordinates from the board centre and the mean entry $\bar{s} = (N+1)/2$,

$$x_j = j - \frac{n-1}{2}, \qquad y_i = \frac{n-1}{2} - i, \qquad z_{ij} = s_{ij} - \frac{N+1}{2}, \tag{1}$$

lifts each cell (i, j) into a three-dimensional point and radial vector from the origin $O = (0, 0, 0)$:

$$\mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda) = (x_j,\, y_i,\, \lambda z_{ij}) \in \mathbb{R}^3, \qquad P_S(\lambda) = \big\{\mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda) : 0 \le i, j < n\big\},$$

where $\lambda > 0$ is the vertical lift scale (Figure 3(a)). The convex hull

$$\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S) := \operatorname{conv} P_S(\lambda) \subset \mathbb{R}^3 \qquad \big(\mathcal{G}(S) := \mathcal{G}_1(S)\big)$$

is a three-dimensional convex polyhedron that we call the *Magic Gem* of S, reuniting Dürer's magic squares with his polyhedral geometry.

In the flat grid plane, Loly [11] and Rogers and Loly [16, 17] showed that interpreting the unequal entries s_{ij} as point masses at $\mathbf{r}_{ij} = (x_j, y_i)$ places the planar centre of mass at the origin O ($\sum_{i,j} z_{ij}\mathbf{r}_{ij} = \mathbf{0}$) and makes the polar moment of inertia $\sum_{i,j} s_{ij}(x_j^2 + y_i^2) = n^2(n^4 - 1)/12$ invariant across all semi-magic squares of order n. When we fabricate a lifted magic square as a three-dimensional physical object—as a radial spoke star, a planar balance wheel, a spinning top on a pivot, a cast solid, a 3D-printed wireframe, a folded papercraft shell, or a tower of blocks [12]—we subject its unequal entries to nonlinear geometric transformations. This motivates one central hypothesis across all physical realizations:

> ***Central Hypothesis (Balance in Inequality).*** *Combinatorial line-sum equality guarantees physical equilibrium whenever a mechanical observable is linear or symmetric-quadratic in the grid coordinates, neutralizing entry inequality universally across all* 880 *order-four magic squares. As soon as a physical realization introduces a nonlinear geometric constraint—normalizing spoke lengths, weighting rotating vertices by their unequal heights, wrapping points in their 3D convex hull, or stacking slanted facets—hidden higher-order inequalities break equilibrium; yet in each regime, exact balance is restored by pairing two opposing inequalities that cancel each other.*

We test this hypothesis through four progressive mechanical experiments, illustrated on six recurring flagship squares (Figure 1):

1. **Test 1: 1D Radial Rays from the Origin (Section 2).** Natural spoke vectors $\mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda)$ balance at O because unequal lengths compensate unequal directions. Trimming all 16 spokes to equal unit length breaks balance on 832 squares in 3D and on *every* square in 2D, where the irrational middle-to-inner ring radius ratio $r_2/r_1 = \sqrt{5}$ prevents the inner and outer rings from cancelling the middle ring beyond the Pell convergent $9/4 \approx \sqrt{5}$ (square #70, Figure 1(b)). By *length–weight duality* (Proposition 2.2), equilibrium is restored by playing unequal positive tip weights $\mathbf{w}^* > \mathbf{0}$ against unit 3D lengths (Theorem 2.5) or by power-law spoke scaling r^{α^*} where aligned ring dipoles cancel (such as $\alpha^* = -1$ on #45, Figure 1(c)).

2. **Test 2: 3D Rotational Precession vs. Dzhanibekov Tumbling (Section 3).** When the 16 unequal points $\mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda)$ carry equal masses, line-sum balance eliminates all off-diagonal inertia moments, making every semi-magic square a smooth axisymmetric rotor that passes through an exact spherical top at $\lambda_{\text{iso}} = (n^2+1)^{-1/2}$ (Theorem 3.1). Replacing equal masses with the unequal magic entries $m_{ij} = s_{ij}$ (Theorem 3.2) exposes the quadrant quadrupole $Q_{xy} = \sum z_{ij}x_j y_i$, splitting the horizontal principal axes by $2|Q_{xy}|$ and triggering 180° Dzhanibekov flips on 824 squares (led by #46, Figure 1(d)).



Figure 1: Visual anatomy of the six flagship order-four magic squares across Tests 1–4 (Sections 2–5). (a) Dürer's associative square #175 (1514, Group III), whose antipodal pairs sum to 17 across O, partitioning into 12 outer hull vertices V_0 and 4 inner core vertices $V_1 = \{6, 7, 10, 11\}$. (b) Square #70 (Group VI), coloured by concentric rings $R_{\text{in}}, R_{\text{mid}}, R_{\text{out}}$, where parallel ring dipoles $\mathbf{d}_{\text{out}} = (15, 0) = 5\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}}$ achieve the fundamental Pell ratio $\|\mathbf{v}\|/\|\mathbf{u}\| = 18/8 = 9/4 \approx \sqrt{5}$. (c) Square #45 ($\kappa = +9$, inverse-radial root $\alpha^* = -1$, heavy core $\Delta\rho_1/\rho_0 = +85/61$), where swapping the single outer border pair $(8, 9) \leftrightarrow (15, 2)$ between rows 2 and 3 yields sibling #54 with the same $(V_0, V_1) = (10, 6)$ vertex partition but a nearly hollow core cavity ($\Delta\rho_1/\rho_0 = -57/58$). (d) Square #46 (Group VI), shaded by cell quadrupole contribution $z_i x_j y_i$, attaining the global maximum $|Q_{xy}| = 60$ ($I_1 = 110 < I_2 = 230 < I_3 = 340$) and fastest 180° Dzhanibekov flip about $y = -x$. (e) Square #673 (Group VI), whose 8 outer vertices form a U-cradle V_0 enclosing an 8-vertex inverted-T core V_1, achieving the minimum solid excess density $\Delta\rho_1/\rho_0 = 5/4$. (f) Square #763 (Group VI), whose centred 2×1 knight's-move facets $\{13, 14, 15, 16\}$ and $\{1, 2, 3, 4\}$ lock into an area-5 mirror-twin tower, and whose single border-pair swap $(16, 1) \leftrightarrow (4, 13)$ produces the naturally balanced solid #756 ($\mathbf{c}_0 = \mathbf{0}$).

3. **Test 3: 3D Convex Hulls and "Diamond-in-a-Diamond" Counterweighting (Section 4).** Casting the uniform solid convex hull $\mathcal{G}_0(S) = \operatorname{conv} P_S$ breaks centroid balance on 829 squares by discarding the interior points $P_S^{(1)}$ and weighting facets by unequal simplex volumes. Because $\sum \mathbf{p}_{ij} = \mathbf{0}$, the outer hull vertices and inner core points pull in strictly opposite directions ($V_0 \overline{\mathbf{p}}_{\text{outer}} = -V_1 \overline{\mathbf{p}}_{\text{inner}}$, Proposition 4.2). Re-engaging the inner core $\mathcal{G}_1(S) = \operatorname{conv} P_S^{(1)}$ restores $\mathbf{c} = \mathbf{0}$ across solids (heavier core #673 and hollow cavity #54, Theorem 4.3), two-gauge wireframes and complete K_{16} strut networks (Theorem 4.4), and unfolded papercraft shells with $f_0 - 1$ glue tabs (Proposition 4.5).

4. **Test 4: Freestanding Gravity and Mirror-Twin Towers (Section 5).** Placing a gem on a table or stacking identical copies fails along steeply slanted facets because upper and lower normals rarely oppose each other ($\mathbf{n}_- \neq -\mathbf{n}_+$ on 756 gems). Compressing the vertical lift to $\lambda_{\text{cube}} = 1/5$ stabilizes 74.5% of all resting facets (Proposition 5.2), while alternating $\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S)$ with its inverted mirror twin $\mathcal{G}_\lambda(r^2\overline{S}) = -\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S)$ (Theorem 5.3) pairs every slanted facet with an equal and opposite partner, locking chiral knight's-move blocks (#763, Figure 1(f)) into a vertical tower (Proposition 5.4).

Across all four tests, our censuses are governed by a single three-tier symmetry hierarchy (Section 6): properties linear in the magic constraints hold universally across all 880 **squares**;

pointwise nonlinear cancellations hold on the 48 **associative squares** of Dudeney's Group III ($r^2S = \overline{S}$, such as Dürer's #175, where central inversion $\mathbf{p}_{-c} = -\mathbf{p}_c$ cancels opposite cells pairwise); and one-parameter counterbalancing between opposing layers or rings occurs in the 304 **self-complementary squares** of Dudeney's Group VI ($\overline{S} = hS$ or vS, where a 180° half-turn symmetry $C_2 \subset SO(3)$ confines residual imbalance vectors to a single coordinate axis). Every result is certified in exact rational arithmetic by `anc/verify_paper_c.py` (Section A) and paired with real-time 3D simulations in `web/index.html`.

Conventions and notation. Let $A_n = \{(x_j, y_i) : 0 \le i, j < n\}$ denote the centred grid (1), let $a_n = (n^2-1)/12$ and $b_n = (n^4-1)/12 = (n^2+1)a_n$ denote the marginal variances of x_j and z_{ij}, and let the dihedral group $D_4 = \langle r, h \rangle$ (with 90° rotation r and reflections h, v) act on arrangements together with the complement involution $\tau(S) = \overline{S} = (N+1)\mathbf{1} - S$. Companion preprints [13, 14] treat the static polyhedral combinatorics and bivariate Prouhet–Tarry–Escott moment hierarchy of semi-magic squares; the present paper is self-contained. Order-four magic squares are numbered #1, ..., #880 by their 1-based position in Frénicle's standard list (`anc/squares880.txt`).

2 Test 1: Radial Spokes from the Origin and Length–Weight Duality

In the fabrication suite `magicGemWeb` [12], the 16 cells of an order-four magic square are built as two radial sculptures pivoted at the origin O: (i) a *3D 16-spoke hub-and-strut star* (`magicGem.scad`, Figure 3(a)) with spokes $\mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda) = (x_j, y_i, \lambda z_{ij})$ of length $R_{ij}(\lambda) = \|\mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda)\|_2$ along unit directions $\hat{\mathbf{p}}_{ij}(\lambda) = \mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda)/R_{ij}(\lambda) \in S^2$; and (ii) a *planar 16-spoke balance wheel* on a conical fulcrum (`weighted_ring.stl`, Figure 2(a)) with spokes along $\mathbf{r}_{ij} = (x_j, y_i)$ of radius $r_{ij} = \|\mathbf{r}_{ij}\|_2$ and unit direction $\mathbf{u}_{ij} = \mathbf{r}_{ij}/r_{ij} \in S^1$. At natural linear lengths ($L_{ij} = R_{ij}(\lambda)$ or $\ell(r_{ij}) = r_{ij}$), both sculptures balance identically at O because $\sum_{i,j} \mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda) = \mathbf{0}$ and $\sum_{i,j} z_{ij}\mathbf{r}_{ij} = \mathbf{0}$ [11, 17], closing the 16 planar vectors into a head-to-tail polygon (Figure 2(b)).

Our first test probes the mechanism of this equilibrium: *does radial balance reside in the directions of the spokes alone, or does it rely on the unequal spoke lengths compensating the unequal directions? When equalizing spoke lengths breaks balance, how can an opposing inequality in tip weights or power-law lengths restore it?*

2.1 Length–Weight Duality: Why Equalizing Spoke Lengths Breaks Balance

Definition 2.1 (Generalized 3D and planar origin-vector resultants)**.** For an arrangement S of order n and vertical lift scale $\lambda > 0$, let $R_{ij}(\lambda) = \sqrt{x_j^2 + y_i^2 + \lambda^2 z_{ij}^2}$ and $\hat{\mathbf{p}}_{ij}(\lambda) = \mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda)/R_{ij}(\lambda)$ ($\mathbf{0}$ if $R_{ij}(\lambda) = 0$). Given cell weights $w = (w_{ij})$ and prescribed 3D spoke lengths $L = (L_{ij})$, the *3D origin-vector resultant* is

$$\mathbf{V}_{w,L}(S;\lambda) = \sum_{i,j} w_{ij}\, L_{ij}\, \hat{\mathbf{p}}_{ij}(\lambda) = \sum_{R_{ij}(\lambda)>0} \left(\frac{w_{ij} L_{ij}}{R_{ij}(\lambda)}\right) \mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda) \in \mathbb{R}^3. \tag{2}$$

For equal weights $w_{ij} = 1$ and power-law 3D lengths $L_{ij} = R_{ij}(\lambda)^\beta$ ($\beta \in \mathbb{R}$), we write

$$\mathbf{V}_\beta(S;\lambda) := \sum_{i,j} R_{ij}(\lambda)^\beta\, \hat{\mathbf{p}}_{ij}(\lambda) = \sum_{i,j} R_{ij}(\lambda)^{\beta-1}\, \mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda) \in \mathbb{R}^3, \tag{3}$$

and for weighted unit vectors ($L_{ij} = 1$) on S^2, we write $\mathbf{B}^{(3)}_{w,\lambda}(S) := \mathbf{V}_{w,1}(S;\lambda) = \sum_{i,j} w_{ij}\hat{\mathbf{p}}_{ij}(\lambda)$. Similarly, in the grid plane, given cell masses $m = (m_{ij})$ and a radial length profile $\ell\colon [0,\infty) \to [0,\infty)$ along unit rays $\mathbf{u}_{ij} = \mathbf{r}_{ij}/r_{ij}$, the *planar radial resultant* is

$$\mathbf{B}_{m,\ell}(S) = \sum_{i,j} m_{ij}\, \ell(r_{ij})\, \mathbf{u}_{ij} = \sum_{r_{ij}>0} \left(\frac{m_{ij}\ell(r_{ij})}{r_{ij}}\right) (x_j, y_i) \in \mathbb{R}^2. \tag{4}$$

Because $\ell(r_{ij})$ depends only on the radius r_{ij}, grid symmetry gives $\sum_{i,j} \ell(r_{ij})\mathbf{u}_{ij} = \mathbf{0}$, so replacing the positive entry masses $m_{ij} = s_{ij} = \bar{s} + z_{ij}$ by the signed heights $m_{ij} = z_{ij}$ leaves the planar resultant unchanged: $\mathbf{B}_{s,\ell}(S) = \mathbf{B}_{z,\ell}(S)$.

Proposition 2.2 (Length–weight duality and the order-three two-ring warm-up)**.** *Let $n \geq 3$ and $\lambda > 0$.*

1. (3D and 2D length–weight duality.) *Scaling 3D vector lengths from the origin to L_{ij} with weights w_{ij} produces the same resultant (2) as keeping the natural 3D vectors $\mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda)$ ($L'_{ij} = R_{ij}(\lambda)$) and assigning effective weights $w'_{ij} = w_{ij}L_{ij}/R_{ij}(\lambda)$. In particular:*

   (a) *Power-law 3D vector lengths $L_{ij} = R_{ij}(\lambda)^{\beta}$ with unit weights ($w_{ij} = 1$) are mechanically dual to natural 3D vectors $\mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda)$ with weights $w'_{ij} = R_{ij}(\lambda)^{\beta-1}$.*

   (b) *Unit-length 3D vectors on S^2 ($L_{ij} = 1$) balance identically ($\sum_{i,j} w_{ij}\hat{\mathbf{p}}_{ij}(\lambda) = \mathbf{0}$) for every arrangement S if weighted by their unequal 3D lengths $w_{ij} = c\,R_{ij}(\lambda)$ ($c \in \mathbb{R}$).*

   (c) *In the grid plane, unit vectors $\mathbf{u}_{ij}$ balance for every semi-magic square ($\sum_{i,j} m_{ij}\mathbf{u}_{ij} = \mathbf{0}$) whenever $m_{ij} = c\,z_{ij}r_{ij}$, and a radial profile ℓ_{ij} with $m_{ij} = z_{ij}$ balances every semi-magic square if and only if $(\ell_{ij}/r_{ij})\mathbf{r}_{ij}$ has components in the row–column subspace $W_{\mathrm{rc}} = \{a(x_j) + b(y_i)\}$.*

2. (Order-three exact formula.) *At order $n = 3$, the eight non-central cells of A_3 lie on two concentric rings: four edge midpoints $R_1 = \{(\pm 1, 0), (0, \pm 1)\}$ ($r_1 = 1$) and four corners $R_{\sqrt{2}} = \{(\pm 1, \pm 1)\}$ ($r_2 = \sqrt{2}$). Every semi-magic square S of order 3 satisfies $\mathbf{d}_1(S)+\mathbf{d}_2(S) = \mathbf{0}$, where $\mathbf{d}_k(S) = \sum_{(i,j)\in R_k} z_{ij}\mathbf{r}_{ij}$, and hence*

$$\mathbf{B}_{z,\ell}(S) = \left(\ell(1) - \frac{\ell(\sqrt{2})}{\sqrt{2}}\right)\mathbf{d}_1(S). \tag{5}$$

   For all eight magic squares of order 3 (the D_4-orbit of the Lo Shu square), $\|\mathbf{d}_1(S)\|_2 = \sqrt{80} = 4\sqrt{5}$, giving

$$\|\mathbf{B}_{z,\ell}(S)\|_2 = 4\sqrt{5}\left|\ell(1) - \frac{\ell(\sqrt{2})}{\sqrt{2}}\right|, \qquad \|\mathbf{B}_{\mathrm{unit}}(S)\|_2 = 4\sqrt{5} - 2\sqrt{10} \approx 2.619717. \tag{6}$$

   Thus $\mathbf{B}_{z,\ell}(S) = \mathbf{0}$ at $n = 3$ if and only if $\ell(\sqrt{2}) = \sqrt{2}\,\ell(1)$.

Proof. Part (1) follows directly from (2)–(4), the identity $\sum_{i,j} \mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda) = \mathbf{0}$, and the characterization of W_{rc} as the orthogonal complement of the zero-line-sum space [14, Sect. 2]. In Part (2), $\mathbf{r}_{11} = (0, 0)$ implies $\mathbf{d}_1(S) + \mathbf{d}_2(S) = \sum_{i,j} z_{ij}\mathbf{r}_{ij} = \mathbf{0}$ for every semi-magic square, which yields (5) upon grouping (4) over R_1 and $R_{\sqrt{2}}$. Evaluating $\mathbf{d}_1 = (-8, 4)$ on the Lo Shu square gives $\|\mathbf{d}_1\|_2 = \sqrt{80} = 4\sqrt{5}$, and D_4-invariance of the Euclidean norm yields (6). □

Proposition 2.2 makes the mechanics of spoke normalization transparent: forcing unequal spokes to equal unit length ($L_{ij} = 1$ or $\ell = 1$) divides each coordinate vector by its irrational radius $R_{ij}(\lambda)$ or r_{ij}. At order $n = 3$, the corner ring sits at an irrational ratio $r_2/r_1 = \sqrt{2}$, so equalizing the spoke lengths breaks the cancellation between $\mathbf{d}_1$ and $\mathbf{d}_2 = -\mathbf{d}_1$. We now see how this irrationality mechanism operates across the three concentric rings of order $n = 4$.

2.2 Planar Balance Wheels: The $\sqrt{5}$ Irrationality Barrier and Power-Law Restoration

At order $n = 4$, the sixteen cells of $A_4 = \{-\frac{3}{2}, -\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{2}, \frac{3}{2}\}^2$ partition into three concentric rings around the origin O (Figure 1(b), Figure 2(a)):

$$R_{\text{in}} = \{(\pm\tfrac{1}{2}, \pm\tfrac{1}{2})\} \qquad \text{(4 inner cells,} \quad r_1 = \tfrac{\sqrt{2}}{2}\text{)},$$
$$R_{\text{mid}} = \{(\pm\tfrac{3}{2}, \pm\tfrac{1}{2}), (\pm\tfrac{1}{2}, \pm\tfrac{3}{2})\} \qquad \text{(8 edge-interior cells,} \quad r_2 = \tfrac{\sqrt{10}}{2}\text{)},$$
$$R_{\text{out}} = \{(\pm\tfrac{3}{2}, \pm\tfrac{3}{2})\} \qquad \text{(4 corner cells,} \quad r_3 = \tfrac{3\sqrt{2}}{2}\text{)}.$$

Whereas the outer and inner radii have a rational ratio $r_3/r_1 = 3$, the middle and inner radii have the irrational ratio $r_2/r_1 = \sqrt{5} \notin \mathbb{Q}$. Consequently, when spokes are trimmed to unit length ($\alpha = 0$), the inner and outer rings combine into a rational lattice vector $\mathbf{u}(S)$ that attempts to cancel an irrational multiple $\mathbf{v}(S)/\sqrt{5}$ from the middle ring.

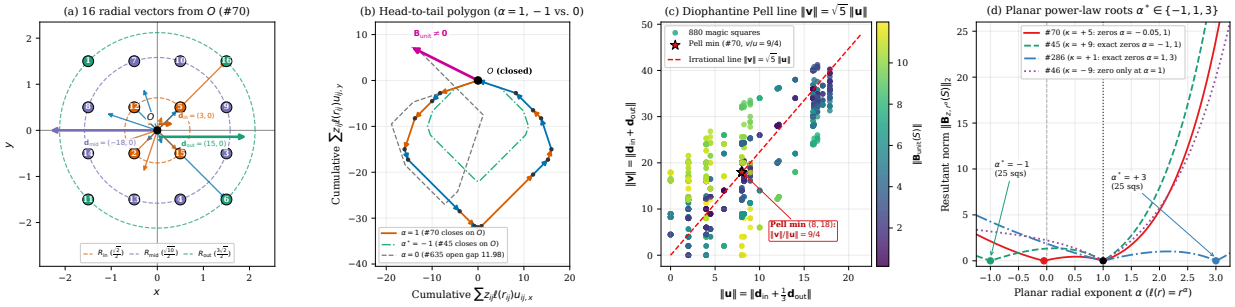


Figure 2: Planar radial vectors from the origin $O = (0, 0)$, head-to-tail polygon closure, and the Diophantine Pell minimum at order four. (a) The 16 radial vectors $z_{ij}\mathbf{r}_{ij}$ radiating from O (orange $z_{ij} > 0$ outward, blue $z_{ij} < 0$ inward) across the three concentric rings $R_{\text{in}}, R_{\text{mid}}, R_{\text{out}}$ on square #70, together with the three ring dipole resultants $\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}} = (3, 0)$, $\mathbf{d}_{\text{out}} = (15, 0)$, and $\mathbf{d}_{\text{mid}} = (-18, 0)$. (b) Placing the 16 vectors $z_{ij}\ell(r_{ij})\mathbf{u}_{ij}$ head-to-tail in order of angle around O produces a closed 16-gon at linear lengths $\alpha = 1$ ($\ell(r) = r$ on #70, solid orange/blue) and at inverse radial lengths $\alpha^* = -1$ ($\ell(r) = 1/r$ on #45, green dash-dot), whereas unit lengths $\alpha = 0$ ($\ell(r) = 1$ on #635, dashed) fail to close by the magenta gap vector $\mathbf{B}_{\text{unit}}(S)$. (c) Scatter plot of $\|\mathbf{v}(S)\|_2 = \|\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}} + \mathbf{d}_{\text{out}}\|_2$ versus $\|\mathbf{u}(S)\|_2 = \|\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}} + \frac{1}{3}\mathbf{d}_{\text{out}}\|_2$ across all 880 magic squares against the irrational balance line $\|\mathbf{v}\| = \sqrt{5}\,\|\mathbf{u}\|$, with the eight Pell-minimum squares ($v/u = 9/4$) marked by red stars. (d) Resultant norm $\|\mathbf{B}_{z,r^\alpha}(S)\|_2$ versus power-law exponent α, highlighting the universal root at $\alpha = 1$ and the exact second roots at $\alpha^* = -1$ (#45, $\kappa = +9$), $\alpha^* = -0.050$ (#70, $\kappa = +5$), and $\alpha^* = +3$ (#286, $\kappa = +1$).

Theorem 2.3 (Three-Ring Decomposition, Irrationality No-Go, and Pell Minimum)**.** *For any arrangement S of order 4, define the three ring dipole vectors radiating from O:*

$$\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}}(S) = \sum_{c \in R_{\text{in}}} z_c \mathbf{r}_c, \qquad \mathbf{d}_{\text{mid}}(S) = \sum_{c \in R_{\text{mid}}} z_c \mathbf{r}_c, \qquad \mathbf{d}_{\text{out}}(S) = \sum_{c \in R_{\text{out}}} z_c \mathbf{r}_c.$$

1. (Ring sums, integrality, and non-vanishing.) *For every 4×4 arrangement S of distinct integers, $\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}}(S) \neq \mathbf{0}$ and $\mathbf{d}_{\text{out}}(S) \neq \mathbf{0}$. For every order-four magic square $S \in \mathcal{M}_4$, both R_{in} and R_{out} sum to $\mu_4 = 34$ (so $\sum_{c \in R_{\text{in}}} z_c = \sum_{c \in R_{\text{out}}} z_c = 0$), and hence $\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}}(S) \in \mathbb{Z}^2 \setminus \{\mathbf{0}\}$ and $\mathbf{d}_{\text{out}}(S) \in (3\mathbb{Z})^2 \setminus \{\mathbf{0}\}$, with*

$$\|\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}}(S)\|_2 \geq 1, \qquad \|\mathbf{d}_{\text{out}}(S)\|_2 \geq 3. \tag{7}$$

2. (Three-ring formula.) *Whenever $\sum_{c \in A_4} z_c \mathbf{r}_c = \mathbf{0}$ (in particular, for every semi-magic square), $\mathbf{d}_{\text{mid}}(S) = -\big(\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}}(S) + \mathbf{d}_{\text{out}}(S)\big)$, and for every radial length profile $\ell = (\ell_1, \ell_2, \ell_3)$ on (r_1, r_2, r_3),*

$$\mathbf{B}_{z,\ell}(S) = \left(\frac{\ell_1}{r_1} - \frac{\ell_2}{r_2}\right)\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}}(S) + \left(\frac{\ell_3}{r_3} - \frac{\ell_2}{r_2}\right)\mathbf{d}_{\text{out}}(S). \tag{8}$$

3. (No-go theorem for unit vectors and even power laws.) *For planar unit vectors ($\ell_1 = \ell_2 = \ell_3 = 1$, i.e. $\alpha = 0$), substituting $1/r_1 = \sqrt{2}$, $1/r_3 = \sqrt{2}/3$, and $1/r_2 = \sqrt{2}/\sqrt{5}$ into (8) separates the rational $\sqrt{2}$ coefficients from the irrational $\sqrt{2}/\sqrt{5}$ coefficient:*

$$\mathbf{B}_{\text{unit}}(S) = \sqrt{2}\left(\mathbf{u}(S) - \frac{1}{\sqrt{5}}\,\mathbf{v}(S)\right), \tag{9}$$

where $\mathbf{u}(S) = \mathbf{d}_{\text{in}}(S) + \frac{1}{3}\mathbf{d}_{\text{out}}(S) \in \mathbb{Z}^2$ collects the inner and outer ring contributions and $\mathbf{v}(S) = \mathbf{d}_{\text{in}}(S) + \mathbf{d}_{\text{out}}(S) = -\mathbf{d}_{\text{mid}}(S) \in \mathbb{Z}^2$ is the negative middle-ring dipole. Because $\sqrt{5} \notin \mathbb{Q}$ and $\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}}(S), \mathbf{d}_{\text{out}}(S) \neq \mathbf{0}$, no 4×4 arrangement of distinct integers with vanishing first moments (and hence no 4×4 semi-magic or magic square) ever satisfies $\mathbf{B}_{\text{unit}}(S) = \mathbf{0}$, *nor can $\mathbf{B}_{z,r^\alpha}(S) = \mathbf{0}$ hold for any even integer $\alpha \in 2\mathbb{Z}$.*

4. (Exact Diophantine Pell minimum over $\mathcal{M}_4$.) *Across all* 880 *magic squares of order* 4, *the global minimum of $\|\mathbf{B}_{\text{unit}}(S)\|_2$ is*

$$\min_{S \in \mathcal{M}_4} \|\mathbf{B}_{\text{unit}}(S)\|_2 = \frac{18\sqrt{10}}{5} - 8\sqrt{2} = \frac{2\sqrt{10}}{5(9+4\sqrt{5})} = \frac{2\sqrt{10}}{5\varphi^6} \approx 0.07049108, \tag{10}$$

where $\varphi = (1+\sqrt{5})/2$. This minimum is attained when $\mathbf{d}_{\text{out}}(S) = 5\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}}(S)$ with $\|\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}}(S)\|_2 = 3$, where $\mathbf{u}(S)$ and $\mathbf{v}(S)$ are parallel in the ratio $\|\mathbf{v}\|/\|\mathbf{u}\| = 18/8 = 9/4$, the fundamental Pell convergent to $\sqrt{5}$ ($9^2 - 5 \cdot 4^2 = 1$). Up to D_4-symmetry, exactly eight magic squares achieve (10): squares #70, #76, #121, #188, #452, #459, #490, and #574, all in Dudeney's Group VI.

Proof. (1) Labelling the four entries of R_{in} at $(-\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{2})$, $(\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{2})$, $(-\frac{1}{2}, -\frac{1}{2})$, $(\frac{1}{2}, -\frac{1}{2})$ by $a, b, c, d \in \mathbb{Z}$ gives $\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}}(S) = \frac{1}{2}\big((b+d)-(a+c), (a+b)-(c+d)\big)$. If $\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}}(S) = \mathbf{0}$, then $b+d = a+c$ and $a+b = c+d$; adding and subtracting these equations forces $b = c$ and $a = d$, contradicting that S has distinct entries. For $S \in \mathcal{M}_4$, subtracting the sum of all 16 cells ($4\mu_4$) from the sum of the two outer rows and two outer columns ($R_0 + R_3 + C_0 + C_3 = 4\mu_4$) gives $\sum_{c \in R_{\text{out}}} s_c - \sum_{c \in R_{\text{in}}} s_c = 0$, while the two main diagonals sum to $D_1 + D_2 = \sum_{c \in R_{\text{out}}} s_c + \sum_{c \in R_{\text{in}}} s_c = 2\mu_4$; hence $\sum_{c \in R_{\text{in}}} s_c = \sum_{c \in R_{\text{out}}} s_c = \mu_4 = 34$ (an even integer), which implies $\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}}(S) \in \mathbb{Z}^2 \setminus \{\mathbf{0}\}$. Since the corner coordinates are $(\pm\frac{3}{2}, \pm\frac{3}{2}) = 3(\pm\frac{1}{2}, \pm\frac{1}{2})$, identical algebra gives $\mathbf{d}_{\text{out}}(S) \in (3\mathbb{Z})^2 \setminus \{\mathbf{0}\}$ and (7).

(2) Partitioning $A_4 = R_{\text{in}} \sqcup R_{\text{mid}} \sqcup R_{\text{out}}$ gives $\mathbf{d}_{\text{mid}} = -(\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}} + \mathbf{d}_{\text{out}})$, and substituting this relation into (4) yields (8).

(3) Setting $\ell_1 = \ell_2 = \ell_3 = 1$ with $1/r_1 = \sqrt{2}$, $1/r_2 = \sqrt{2}/\sqrt{5}$, and $1/r_3 = \sqrt{2}/3$ in (8) gives $\mathbf{B}_{\text{unit}}(S) = (\sqrt{2} - \sqrt{2}/\sqrt{5})\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}} + (\sqrt{2}/3 - \sqrt{2}/\sqrt{5})\mathbf{d}_{\text{out}} = \sqrt{2}\big((\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}} + \frac{1}{3}\mathbf{d}_{\text{out}}) - \frac{1}{\sqrt{5}}(\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}} + \mathbf{d}_{\text{out}})\big)$, which is (9). Because $\mathbf{u}(S), \mathbf{v}(S) \in \mathbb{Z}^2$ by (1) and $\sqrt{5} \notin \mathbb{Q}$, $\mathbf{B}_{\text{unit}}(S) = \mathbf{0}$ requires $\mathbf{u}(S) = \mathbf{v}(S) = \mathbf{0}$, which forces $\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}}(S) = \mathbf{d}_{\text{out}}(S) = \mathbf{0}$, contradicting (1). The same irrationality holds for any even exponent $\alpha = 2m$, where $r_2^{\alpha-1}/r_1^{\alpha-1} = 5^{m-1}\sqrt{5} \notin \mathbb{Q}$.

(4) Since $\mathbf{v}(S) - \mathbf{u}(S) = \frac{2}{3}\mathbf{d}_{\text{out}}(S) \in (2\mathbb{Z})^2$, the integer vectors satisfy the parity congruence $\mathbf{u}(S) \equiv \mathbf{v}(S) \pmod 2$ for every semi-magic square, while $\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}}, \mathbf{d}_{\text{out}} \neq \mathbf{0}$ implies $\mathbf{u} \neq \mathbf{v}$ and $\mathbf{v} \neq 3\mathbf{u}$. Decomposing $\mathbf{v}$ parallel and orthogonal to $\mathbf{u}$ shows that $\|\mathbf{u} - \mathbf{v}/\sqrt{5}\|_2$ is minimized when $\mathbf{u} = p\mathbf{e}$ and $\mathbf{v} = q\mathbf{e}$ are collinear along a primitive lattice direction $\mathbf{e} = (a, b) \in \mathbb{Z}^2$ ($\gcd(a, b) = 1$), where $\|\mathbf{B}_{\text{unit}}(S)\|_2 = \sqrt{2(a^2+b^2)}\,|p - q/\sqrt{5}|$ and the prefactor $\sqrt{2(a^2+b^2)}$ is minimal along the coordinate axes ($a^2 + b^2 = 1$). Over all integer pairs with $p \equiv q \pmod 2$, the best approximations to $\sqrt{5}$ are governed by the Pell–Lucas equation $q^2 - 5p^2 = \pm 4$, whose positive solutions $(p, q) = (F_k, L_k)$ alternate between odd–odd Fibonacci–Lucas semiconvergents such as $(3, 7)$, $(5, 11)$, $(13, 29)$, $(21, 47)$ ($k \not\equiv 0 \pmod 3$) and even–even pairs $(F_{3m}, L_{3m}) = 2(p_m, q_m)$ obtained by doubling the principal continued-fraction convergents $q_m/p_m \in \{2/1, 9/4, 38/17, \dots\}$ of $\sqrt{5} = [2; \overline{4}]$. On $\mathcal{M}_4$, every pair (F_k, L_k) with $k \geq 7$ is excluded on two independent grounds:

(i) *Direct axial collinear bound:* Since $\frac{1}{3}\mathbf{d}_{\text{out}} = \frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{v} - \mathbf{u})$ and $\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}} = \frac{1}{2}(3\mathbf{u} - \mathbf{v})$, realizing $(p, q) = (F_k, L_k)$ along a coordinate axis requires $\frac{1}{3}|d_{\text{out}}| = \frac{1}{2}(L_k - F_k)$. Across $\mathcal{M}_4$, $\frac{1}{3}\|\mathbf{d}_{\text{out}}\|_\infty \leq 12$,

which immediately excludes all $k \geq 8$ ($\frac{1}{2}(L_k - F_k) \geq \frac{1}{2}(47-21) = 13 > 12$). For $k = 7$, $(F_7, L_7) = (13, 29)$ requires $\frac{1}{3}|d_{\text{out}}| = \frac{1}{2}(29-13) = 8$ and $|d_{\text{in}}| = \frac{1}{2}(39-29) = 5$; however, saturating $\frac{1}{3}|d_{\text{out}}| = 8$ along a coordinate axis on $\mathcal{M}_4$ constrains the inner-ring dipole on every axial collinear square ($\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}} \parallel \mathbf{d}_{\text{out}}$) to $|d_{\text{in}}| \leq 4$ and hence $p = |d_{\text{in}} + \frac{1}{3}d_{\text{out}}| \leq 12 < 13$.

(ii) *Even-lattice property:* Subtracting $C_1 + C_2 = 2\mu_4$ and $C_0 + C_3 = 2\mu_4$ from $D_1 + D_2 = 2\mu_4$ gives $s_{00} + s_{03} = s_{31} + s_{32}$ and $s_{11} + s_{12} = s_{20} + s_{23}$, and across all 24 modulo-2 parity patterns of $\mathcal{M}_4$ the four top diagonal cells $T_{\text{diag}} = \{(0,0),(0,3),(1,1),(1,2)\}$ (and likewise $R_{\text{diag}} = \{(0,3),(3,3),(1,2),(2,2)\}$) always have an even sum $\sum_{c\in T_{\text{diag}}} s_c \in \{18, 20, \ldots, 42\}$. Because $u_y(S) = \sum_{c\in T_{\text{diag}}} s_c - 34$ and $u_x(S) = \sum_{c\in R_{\text{diag}}} s_c - 34$, every magic square $S \in \mathcal{M}_4$ satisfies

$$\mathbf{u}(S) = 2\tilde{\mathbf{u}}(S) \in (2\mathbb{Z})^2, \quad \mathbf{v}(S) = 2\tilde{\mathbf{v}}(S) \in (2\mathbb{Z})^2, \quad \|\mathbf{u}(S)\|_\infty \leq 16, \quad \|\mathbf{u}(S)\|_2 \leq 8\sqrt{5} \approx 17.89,$$

excluding all odd–odd Pell–Lucas pairs and reducing (9) to $\|\mathbf{B}_{\text{unit}}(S)\|_2 = 2\sqrt{2}\,\|\tilde{\mathbf{u}}(S) - \tilde{\mathbf{v}}(S)/\sqrt{5}\|_2$ with $\tilde{\mathbf{u}}(S), \tilde{\mathbf{v}}(S) \in \mathbb{Z}^2$ and $\|\tilde{\mathbf{u}}(S)\|_2 \leq 4\sqrt{5} < 9$.

By Lagrange's theorem on continued fractions, across all integer denominators $1 \leq \tilde{u} < 17$, the unique best rational approximation to $\sqrt{5}$ is the fundamental Pell convergent $\tilde{v}/\tilde{u} = 9/4$ ($9^2 - 5\cdot 4^2 = 1$), corresponding to $(p, q) = (F_6, L_6) = (8, 18)$ and giving $2\sqrt{2}(9/\sqrt{5} - 4) = 18\sqrt{10}/5 - 8\sqrt{2} = 2\sqrt{10}/(5\varphi^6) \approx 0.07049108$ (since $\varphi^6 = (2+\sqrt{5})^2 = 9 + 4\sqrt{5}$), whereas the next convergent $38/17$ requires $\|\tilde{\mathbf{u}}\|_2 \geq 17 > 4\sqrt{5}$. On square #70 (Figure 1(b)), the inner ring $\{5, 12, 2, 15\}$ gives $\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}} = \frac{1}{2}\big((12+15) - (5+2), (12+5) - (2+15)\big) = (3, 0)$ and the outer corners $\{1, 16, 11, 6\}$ give $\mathbf{d}_{\text{out}} = \frac{3}{2}\big((16+6) - (1+11), (1+16) - (11+6)\big) = (15, 0) = 5\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}}$, realizing $\mathbf{u} = (8, 0)$, $\mathbf{v} = (18, 0)$, and (10). □

How, then, can a planar balance wheel achieve exact equilibrium at a non-linear length profile $\ell(r) = r^\alpha$ ($\alpha \neq 1$)? Equation (8) shows that balance is restored whenever the inner and outer ring dipoles align in the same direction ($\mathbf{d}_{\text{out}} = \kappa\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}}$ with $\kappa > 0$), so that both rings jointly oppose the middle ring $\mathbf{d}_{\text{mid}} = -(1+\kappa)\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}}$ (Figure 2(d)).

Corollary 2.4 (Restoring planar balance via power-law exponents $\alpha^* \neq 1$)**.** *For power-law radial lengths $\ell(r) = r^\alpha$ ($\alpha \in \mathbb{R}$), equation (8) takes the form*

$$\mathbf{B}_{z,r^\alpha}(S) = r_1^{\alpha-1}\Big[\big(1 - 5^{(\alpha-1)/2}\big)\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}}(S) + \big(3^{\alpha-1} - 5^{(\alpha-1)/2}\big)\mathbf{d}_{\text{out}}(S)\Big]. \tag{11}$$

1. *Because $1 < \sqrt{5} < 3$, the ratio $h(\alpha) = \frac{5^{(\alpha-1)/2}-1}{3^{\alpha-1}-5^{(\alpha-1)/2}}$ (extended by $h(1) = \frac{\ln 5}{\ln(9/5)} \approx 2.7381$) is a strictly decreasing bijection from $\mathbb{R}$ onto $(0, \infty)$. Consequently, an order-four magic square S possesses a second power-law balance exponent $\alpha^*(S) \neq 1$ satisfying $\mathbf{B}_{z,r^{\alpha^*}}(S) = \mathbf{0}$ if and only if $\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}}(S)$ and $\mathbf{d}_{\text{out}}(S)$ are strictly parallel ($\mathbf{d}_{\text{out}}(S) = \kappa\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}}(S)$ with $\kappa > 0$), which holds for 204 of the 880 magic squares (while 204 squares have anti-parallel dipoles $\kappa < 0$).*

2. *Across all 880 magic squares, the second root $\alpha^*(\kappa)$ is an integer in only two cases:*

   - *$\alpha^* = -1$ (inverse radial lengths $\ell(r) = 1/r$), corresponding to $\kappa = h(-1) = +9$, achieved by 25 squares (e.g. square #45 in Figure 1(c), where $\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}} = (0, -2)$ and $\mathbf{d}_{\text{out}} = (0, -18) = 9\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}}$);*
   - *$\alpha^* = +3$ (cubic radial lengths $\ell(r) = r^3$), corresponding to $\kappa = h(3) = +1$, achieved by 25 squares (e.g. square #286).*

   For the 17 squares with $\kappa = +5$ (including the eight Pell-minimum squares of Theorem 2.3(4)), the exact zero occurs at $\alpha^*(5) \approx -0.0496$, explaining why $\|\mathbf{B}_{z,r^\alpha}(S)\|_2$ pinches nearly to zero at $\alpha = 0$ (Figure 2(d)).

Proof. Setting (11) to $\mathbf{0}$ for $\alpha \neq 1$ requires $\mathbf{d}_{\text{out}}(S) = h(\alpha)\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}}(S)$. Since $1 < 5^{t/2} < 3^t$ for $t = \alpha - 1 > 0$ and $3^t < 5^{t/2} < 1$ for $t < 0$, both numerator and denominator of $h(\alpha)$ have the sign of $\alpha - 1$, so $h(\alpha) > 0$ with $\lim_{\alpha\to-\infty} h(\alpha) = +\infty$ and $\lim_{\alpha\to+\infty} h(\alpha) = 0$. Since $\kappa \in \mathbb{Q}_{>0}$ cannot equal the transcendental number $\frac{\ln 5}{\ln(9/5)}$, every square with $\kappa > 0$ has a unique root $\alpha^*(\kappa) = h^{-1}(\kappa) \neq 1$. By Theorem 2.3(3), an integer root $\alpha^* \neq 1$ must be odd, $\alpha^* = 2m + 1$ ($m \in \mathbb{Z} \setminus \{0\}$), where $h(2m + 1) = \frac{5^m - 1}{9^m - 5^m}$; comparing this sequence against the 15 positive rational ratios κ realized on $\mathcal{M}_4$ leaves only $m = -1$ ($\kappa = 9$, 25 squares) and $m = +1$ ($\kappa = 1$, 25 squares). □

2.3 Three-Dimensional Spoke Stars: Unit-Sphere Counterweights and Cubic Vertical Balance

We now lift the spoke sculpture into three dimensions (Figure 3). In 3D, trimming all 16 spokes to the unit sphere S^2 ($\beta = 0$) breaks equilibrium on 832 of the 880 squares, sparing only the 48 associative squares of Group III where antipodal pairs cancel pairwise ($\hat{\mathbf{p}}_{-c} = -\hat{\mathbf{p}}_c$). Nevertheless, because the natural unequal lengths $R_{ij}(\lambda) > 0$ satisfy $\sum_{i,j} R_{ij}(\lambda)\hat{\mathbf{p}}_{ij}(\lambda) = \mathbf{0}$, the origin O always lies strictly inside the convex hull of the 16 unit rays, guaranteeing that positive unequal tip weights $\mathbf{w}^* > \mathbf{0}$ restore unit-sphere equilibrium for every magic square.

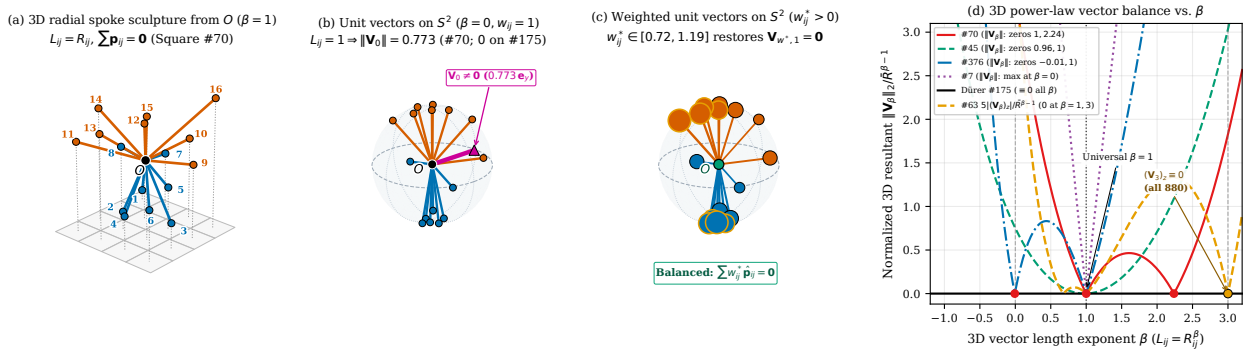


Figure 3: Three-dimensional radial spoke sculptures from the origin $O = (0, 0, 0)$ of variable length and tip weight. (a) The 16-spoke radial sculpture $\mathbf{p}_{ij}$ ($\beta = 1$, spoke length $L_{ij} = R_{ij}$, orange for $z_{ij} > 0$, blue for $z_{ij} < 0$) of non-associative square #70 over the floor grid, balancing identically at the central hub O ($\sum \mathbf{p}_{ij} = \mathbf{0}$). (b) Trimming all 16 spokes to unit length $L_{ij} = 1$ ($\beta = 0$, equal tip weights $w_{ij} = 1$) on the unit sphere S^2 leaves a non-zero resultant $\mathbf{V}_0 = (0, 0.773, 0)$ (magenta arrow) on square #70, whereas antipodal pairs cancel on associative Dürer #175. (c) Assigning the minimum-variance positive tip weights $w^*_{ij} \in [0.72, 1.19]$ (sphere tip sizes, gold-rimmed for $w^*_{ij} > 1$) restores exact unit-sphere balance $\sum w^*_{ij}\hat{\mathbf{p}}_{ij} = \mathbf{0}$ at O. (d) Normalized 3D power-law resultant $\|\mathbf{V}_\beta(S; 1)\|_2/\bar{R}^{\beta-1}$ versus length exponent β, showing universal balance at $\beta = 1$, second power-law roots $\beta^* \neq 1$ on Group VI squares (#70 at $\beta^* = 2.24$, #45 at 0.96, #376 at -0.008), and identical vertical vanishing $(\mathbf{V}_3)_z = 0$ at $\beta = 3$ (gold dashed curve showing $5|(\mathbf{V}_\beta)_z|/\bar{R}^{\beta-1}$ on square #63).

Theorem 2.5 (3D Power-Law Vectors, Cubic Vertical Vanishing, and Positive Unit-Sphere Weights)**.** *Let S be a semi-magic square of order n and let $\lambda > 0$.*

1. (Cubic 3D vector law $\beta = 3$.) *For cubic 3D spoke lengths $L_{ij} = R_{ij}(\lambda)^3$ from the origin (dual by Proposition 2.2(1) to weighting $\mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda)$ by $w_{ij} = R_{ij}(\lambda)^2 = r_{ij}^2 + \lambda^2 z_{ij}^2$), the vertical z-component vanishes identically for every semi-magic square of any order n and every $\lambda > 0$:*

$$\mathbf{V}_3(S; \lambda) = \sum_{i,j} (r_{ij}^2 + \lambda^2 z_{ij}^2)(x_j, y_i, \lambda z_{ij}) = \left(\lambda^2 \sum_{i,j} z_{ij}^2 x_j, \quad \lambda^2 \sum_{i,j} z_{ij}^2 y_i, \quad 0\right). \tag{12}$$

   At order $n = 4$, $\mathbf{V}_3(S; \lambda) = \mathbf{0}$ if and only if S is one of the 48 associative magic squares.

2. (Unit-sphere parity and Group VI power-law roots.) *Under any even weight function $w_{ij} = f(|z_{ij}|)$, every associative square satisfies $\hat{\mathbf{p}}_{-c}(\lambda) = -\hat{\mathbf{p}}_c(\lambda)$ and hence $\mathbf{V}_\beta(S; \lambda) = \mathbf{0}$ for*

all $\beta \in \mathbb{R}$ *and* $\lambda > 0$. *At* $n = 4$, $\mathbf{V}_0(S;\lambda) = \mathbf{0}$ *holds if and only if* S *is one of the* 48 *associative squares (*$\|\mathbf{V}_0(S;1)\|_2 \in [0.0072, 2.4284]$ *on the remaining* 832 *squares). Among the* 304 *Group VI squares (where* C_2 *symmetry confines* $\mathbf{V}_\beta(S;\lambda)$ *to a single coordinate axis),* 107 *squares possess a second 3D power-law balance exponent* $\beta^*(S) \in [-3,4] \setminus \{1\}$ *with* $\mathbf{V}_{\beta^*}(S;1) = \mathbf{0}$ *(Figure 3(d)).*

3. (Universal positive minimum-variance balancing weights on S^2.) *Letting* $\hat{P}(\lambda) \in \mathbb{R}^{N\times 3}$ *have rows* $\hat{\mathbf{p}}_{ij}(\lambda)^\top$, *the unique weight vector* $\mathbf{w}^*(S;\lambda)$ *of minimum Euclidean distance* $\|\mathbf{w} - \mathbf{1}\|_2$ *from uniform weights* $\mathbf{1}$ *satisfying* $\sum_{i,j} w^*_{ij}\hat{\mathbf{p}}_{ij}(\lambda) = \mathbf{0}$ *is*

$$\mathbf{w}^*(S;\lambda) = \mathbf{1} - \hat{P}(\lambda)\big(\hat{P}(\lambda)^\top \hat{P}(\lambda)\big)^{-1}\mathbf{V}_0(S;\lambda). \tag{13}$$

Across all 880 *order-four magic squares at* $\lambda = 1$, $\lambda_{\text{iso}} = 1/\sqrt{17}$, *and* $\lambda_{\text{cube}} = 0.20$, *every square admits strictly positive optimal weights* $\mathbf{w}^*(S;\lambda) > \mathbf{0}$ *(Figure 3(c)), with* $\|\mathbf{w}^*(S;1) - \mathbf{1}\|_2 \in [0.0052, 1.5967]$ *across the* 832 *non-associative squares.*

Proof. (1) Expanding $\mathbf{V}_3(S;\lambda) = \sum_{i,j}(r_{ij}^2 + \lambda^2 z_{ij}^2)(x_j, y_i, \lambda z_{ij})$, the horizontal sum $\sum_{i,j} r_{ij}^2(x_j, y_i)$ vanishes by odd grid symmetry, leaving $\lambda^2 \sum_{i,j} z_{ij}^2(x_j, y_i)$. The vertical component is $\lambda \sum_{i,j}(x_j^2 + y_i^2)z_{ij} + \lambda^3 \sum_{i,j} z_{ij}^3$; here $\sum_{i,j}(x_j^2 + y_i^2)z_{ij} = 0$ because $x_j^2 + y_i^2 \in W_{\text{rc}}$, and $\sum_{i,j} z_{ij}^3 = 0$ by odd symmetry of $\{z_{ij}\}$, proving (12).

(2) For associative squares, $z(-x,-y) = -z(x,y)$ implies $\mathbf{p}_{-c}(\lambda) = -\mathbf{p}_c(\lambda)$ and $R_{-c}(\lambda) = R_c(\lambda)$, so opposite cells cancel pairwise for every $\beta \in \mathbb{R}$.

(3) Minimizing $\frac{1}{2}\|\mathbf{w} - \mathbf{1}\|_2^2$ subject to $\hat{P}(\lambda)^\top \mathbf{w} = \mathbf{0}$ by Lagrange multipliers gives (13), and exact enumeration over the 880 squares establishes positivity and the stated bounds. □

Notice how the cubic resultant $\mathbf{V}_3(S;\lambda)$ in (12) bridges static rays and rotational dynamics: while its vertical component vanishes for every semi-magic square, its residual horizontal dipole $\lambda^2 \sum_{i,j} z_{ij}^2(x_j, y_i)$ measures the quadratic height asymmetry across the grid. In Test 2, we set our sculptures into three-dimensional rotation and see that this exact vector governs the vertical off-diagonal products of inertia of an entry-weighted gem.

3 Test 2: Rotational Dynamics—Equal Masses Precess, Entry Masses Flip

Our second test moves from static radial equilibrium to three-dimensional rotation. Suppose a Magic Gem or radial spoke sculpture of total mass M and centre of mass $\mathbf{c}$ is supported on a low-friction conical pivot or gimbal at the origin O under uniform gravity $\mathbf{g} = (0, 0, -g)^\top$ (generalizing the conical fulcrum of `weighted_ring.stl` in [12]), or tossed in free space. About the pivot O, gravity exerts the torque

$$\boldsymbol{\tau}_{\text{grav}} = M\,\mathbf{c} \times \mathbf{g},$$

which *vanishes identically in every 3D orientation if and only if the centre of mass lies at the pivot (*$\mathbf{c} = \mathbf{0}$*).* Consequently, any balanced sculpture ($\mathbf{c} = \mathbf{0}$) supported at O rotates under Earth's gravity according to Euler's exact torque-free equations [2, 10]: in the principal body frame, the angular velocity vector $\boldsymbol{\omega} = (\omega_1, \omega_2, \omega_3)^\top$ evolves via

$$I_1\dot{\omega}_1 = (I_2 - I_3)\omega_2\omega_3, \qquad I_2\dot{\omega}_2 = (I_3 - I_1)\omega_3\omega_1, \qquad I_3\dot{\omega}_3 = (I_1 - I_2)\omega_1\omega_2, \tag{14}$$

where I_1, I_2, I_3 are the principal moments of inertia. For an asymmetric body with three distinct principal moments $I_1 < I_2 < I_3$, rotation about the intermediate axis I_2 is exponentially unstable: any small perturbation grows at rate $\sqrt{(I_2 - I_1)(I_3 - I_2)/(I_1 I_3)}\,|\omega_2|$, causing the body to execute the 180° flips of the Dzhanibekov (or tennis-racket) theorem [3, 15].

Test 2 asks: *when the* 16 *unequal heights* z_{ij} *are set spinning in* $\mathbb{R}^3$, *do their geometric inequalities produce an asymmetric top that tumbles via Dzhanibekov flips, or does line-sum equality enforce smooth axisymmetric precession?*

3.1 Equal Masses at Unequal Heights Form a Universal Axisymmetric Rotor

Consider first the discrete point cloud $P_S(\lambda) = \{\mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda) = (x_j, y_i, \lambda z_{ij})\}$ carrying equal point masses $m = M/N$ at the $N = n^2$ unequal lifted points (for instance, identical steel bearings mounted at the tips of the sixteen radial spokes $\mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda)$ on a lightweight hub at O). Because $\mathbf{c} = \frac{1}{N}\sum_{i,j}\mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda) = \mathbf{0}$, gravitational torque about O vanishes identically for every semi-magic square, and the magic line sums neutralize all off-diagonal products of inertia.

Theorem 3.1 (Universal symmetric-top law, spherical-top scale, and periodic polhodes)**.** *Let S be any arrangement of $\{1, \dots, n^2\}$ ($n \geq 2$) whose height field has vanishing first moments $\sum_{i,j} x_j z_{ij} = \sum_{i,j} y_i z_{ij} = 0$ (in particular, any semi-magic or magic square), and place equal point masses $m = M/N$ at the points $\mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda) = (x_j, y_i, \lambda z_{ij})$.*

1. (Axisymmetric inertia tensor.) *For every $\lambda > 0$, the inertia tensor about the origin O,*

$$I(\lambda) = \frac{M}{N}\sum_{i,j}\Big(\|\mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda)\|_2^2\, I_3 - \mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda)\mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda)^\top\Big),$$

is diagonal and strictly axisymmetric about the z-axis:

$$I(\lambda) = M\,\mathrm{diag}\big(I_\perp(\lambda),\, I_\perp(\lambda),\, I_{zz}\big), \qquad I_\perp(\lambda) = a_n + \lambda^2 b_n, \qquad I_{zz} = 2a_n, \tag{15}$$

with universal principal inertia ratio

$$\frac{I_\perp(\lambda)}{I_{zz}} = \frac{a_n + \lambda^2 b_n}{2a_n} = \frac{1 + \lambda^2(n^2+1)}{2}. \tag{16}$$

2. (Three critical aspect ratios.) *Varying the vertical lift scale λ drives the rotor through three regimes (Figure 4(a)):*

   (a) *At the* canonical lift $\lambda = 1$,

$$\frac{I_\perp(1)}{I_{zz}} = \frac{n^2+2}{2}, \tag{17}$$

   which is an exact integer for every even order n (9 for $n = 4$, 19 for $n = 6$, 33 for $n = 8$) and a half-integer for every odd order n (11/2 for $n = 3$, 27/2 for $n = 5$).

   (b) *At the* spherical-top critical scale

$$\lambda_{\mathrm{iso}}(n) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{n^2+1}} \qquad \Big(\tfrac{1}{\sqrt{10}} \approx 0.3162 \text{ for } n = 3, \quad \tfrac{1}{\sqrt{17}} \approx 0.2425 \text{ for } n = 4\Big), \tag{18}$$

   $I_\perp(\lambda_{\mathrm{iso}}) = I_{zz} = 2a_n$, *so $I(\lambda_{\mathrm{iso}}) = 2Ma_nI_3$ is a scalar multiple of the identity: the point-weighted gem is a* spherical top *for which every axis through O in $\mathbb{R}^3$ is a principal axis of inertia.*

   (c) *At the* cubic bounding-box scale $\lambda_{\mathrm{cube}}(n) = \frac{n-1}{n^2-1} = \frac{1}{n+1}$ *(where the vertical span matches the horizontal footprint $[-\frac{n-1}{2}, \frac{n-1}{2}]^2$, giving $\lambda_{\mathrm{cube}} = 1/5 = 0.20$ at $n = 4$),*

$$\frac{I_\perp(\lambda_{\mathrm{cube}})}{I_{zz}} = \frac{n^2+n+1}{(n+1)^2} \qquad \Big(\frac{21}{25} = 0.84 \text{ at } n = 4\Big). \tag{19}$$

3. (Suppression of Dzhanibekov tumbling and rational orbit closure.) *Because $I_{xx}(\lambda) = I_{yy}(\lambda) = I_\perp(\lambda)$, no distinct intermediate principal axis exists. In torque-free motion (14), $\omega_3(t) = \omega_{3,0}$ is constant and the transverse angular velocity $(\omega_1(t), \omega_2(t))$ precesses in a uniform circle at the body-frame polhode frequency*

$$\Omega_{\mathrm{body}}(\lambda) = \frac{I_\perp(\lambda) - I_{zz}}{I_\perp(\lambda)}\,\omega_{3,0} = \frac{\lambda^2(n^2+1) - 1}{\lambda^2(n^2+1) + 1}\,\omega_{3,0}. \tag{20}$$

At $\lambda = 1$, $\Omega_{\text{body}}(1) = \frac{n^2}{n^2+2}\omega_{3,0}$ is a rational multiple of the spin rate $\omega_{3,0}$, so the polhode and space-cone trajectories close periodically after n^2+2 spin revolutions (or $(n^2+2)/2 = 9$ revolutions at $n = 4$). At $\lambda = \lambda_{\text{iso}}(n)$, $\Omega_{\text{body}} = 0$ and the gem rotates steadily without wobble about any initial angular velocity vector $\boldsymbol{\omega}_0 \in \mathbb{R}^3$.

Proof. By [13, Lem. 3.1], the empirical covariance matrix $\Sigma(\lambda) = \frac{1}{N}\sum_{i,j} \mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda)\mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda)^\top$ has diagonal entries $\Sigma_{xx} = \Sigma_{yy} = a_n = (n^2-1)/12$ and $\Sigma_{zz} = \lambda^2 b_n = \lambda^2(n^4-1)/12 = \lambda^2(n^2+1)a_n$, while $\Sigma_{xy} = 0$ by grid symmetry and $\Sigma_{xz} = \Sigma_{yz} = 0$ by vanishing of the first moments. Since $I(\lambda) = M\big(\operatorname{tr}(\Sigma(\lambda))I_3 - \Sigma(\lambda)\big)$, we obtain (15) and (16). Specializing (16) to $\lambda = 1$, $\lambda = (n^2+1)^{-1/2}$, and $\lambda = (n+1)^{-1}$ yields (2a)–(2c). Substituting $I_1 = I_2 = I_\perp(\lambda)$ and $I_3 = I_{zz}$ into Euler's equations (14) gives $\dot{\omega}_3 = 0$ and $\dot{\omega}_1 = \Omega_{\text{body}}\omega_2$, $\dot{\omega}_2 = -\Omega_{\text{body}}\omega_1$ with Ω_{body} as in (20). □

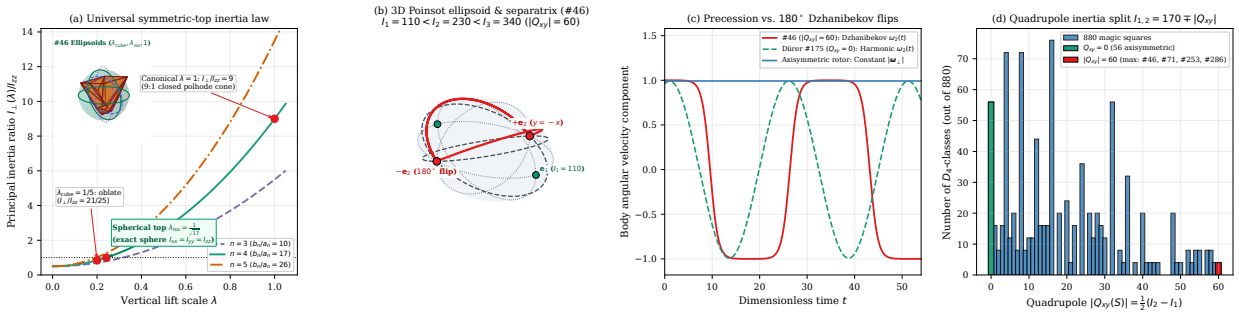


Figure 4: Three-dimensional rotational dynamics of Magic Gems. (a) Universal principal inertia ratio $I_\perp(\lambda)/I_{zz} = \frac{1}{2}(1+\lambda^2(n^2+1))$ versus vertical scale λ for orders $n = 3, 4, 5$, with 3D inertia ellipsoids at the cubic 3D-print scale $\lambda_{\text{cube}} = 1/5$ (21/25), the isotropic spherical-top transition $\lambda_{\text{iso}} = 1/\sqrt{17}$ (1), and the canonical lift $\lambda = 1$ (9) for $n = 4$. (b) Triaxial Poinsot energy ellipsoid $\frac{1}{2}\sum I_k\omega_k^2 = E$ of entry-weighted square #46 ($I_1 = 110 < I_2 = 230 < I_3 = 340$), showing the figure-eight separatrix through the unstable intermediate saddle $\pm\boldsymbol{\omega}_2$ and the heteroclinic polhode orbit connecting $+\omega_2$ to $-\omega_2$. (c) Time series of Euler's equations (14): an axisymmetric magic rotor (Dürer #175 or any point-weighted gem) precesses harmonically with constant $|\boldsymbol{\omega}_\perp|$, whereas entry-weighted square #46 ($|Q_{xy}| = 60$) undergoes periodic 180° Dzhanibekov flips $\omega_2(t) \in [+1, -1]$ about its intermediate diagonal axis. (d) Census of the quadrupole moment $|Q_{xy}(S)| = |\sum z_{ij}x_jy_i| = \frac{1}{2}(I_2 - I_1)$ across the 880 order-four magic squares.

3.2 Unequal Entry Masses Expose Q_{xy} and Trigger Dzhanibekov Flips

What breaks the universal axisymmetric rotation of Theorem 3.1? Weighting each cell by its *unequal magic entry* $m_{ij} = s_{ij}$ (as in the planar balancing wheel `weighted_ring.stl` [12]). While Loly's theorem [11] keeps the diagonal moments equal ($I_{xx} = I_{yy} = I_0$), the unequal masses expose a second-order quadrant inequality—the planar quadrupole moment $Q_{xy}(S) = \sum_{i,j} z_{ij}x_jy_i$—together with the cubic 3D vector resultant $\mathbf{V}_3(S;\lambda)$ from Test 1. On square #46 (Figure 1(d)), for example, the heavy entries $\{16, 13, 15, 14\}$ concentrate in the NW/SE quadrants ($xy < 0$) while the light entries $\{1, 4, 2, 3\}$ sit in the NE/SW quadrants ($xy > 0$). Flicking the board to spin about its intermediate diagonal axis $y = -x$ ($I_2 = 230$) places the angular velocity directly on the saddle of the Poinsot energy ellipsoid (Figure 4(b)), triggering a 180° Dzhanibekov flip (Figure 4(c)).

Theorem 3.2 (Entry-weighted inertia split, quadrupole Dzhanibekov instability, and 3D lifted tensor)**.** *Let S be any semi-magic square of order n, and assign entry masses $m_{ij} = s_{ij} = \bar{s} + z_{ij}$ with total mass $M = \sum_{i,j} s_{ij} = N\bar{s} = n^2(n^2+1)/2$.*

1. (Planar inertia tensor and diagonal principal axes.) *When the masses $m_{ij} = s_{ij}$ are placed at the planar grid positions $(x_j, y_i, 0) \in \mathbb{R}^3$, the centre of mass lies at O and the 3×3 inertia*

tensor about O is

$$I^{(s)}(S) = \begin{pmatrix} I_0 & -Q_{xy}(S) & 0 \\ -Q_{xy}(S) & I_0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 2I_0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad I_0 = Ma_n = \frac{n^2(n^4-1)}{24}, \quad Q_{xy}(S) = \sum_{i,j} z_{ij}x_jy_i. \tag{21}$$

Its principal moments of inertia are

$$I_1(S) = I_0 - |Q_{xy}(S)|, \qquad I_2(S) = I_0 + |Q_{xy}(S)|, \qquad I_3 = 2I_0, \tag{22}$$

with horizontal principal axes directed along the two main diagonals $y = \pm x$.

2. (Order-four Dzhanibekov dichotomy.) *At order $n = 4$, $I_0 = 170$ and $I_3 = 340$. Across the 880 magic squares of order 4 (Figure 4(b–d)):*

   (a) Exactly 56 squares satisfy $Q_{xy}(S) = 0$ (48 associative squares in Group III, including Dürer's #175, plus 8 in Groups IX–X), remaining axisymmetric rotors with $I_1 = I_2 = 170$.

   (b) The remaining 824 squares have $|Q_{xy}(S)| \in \{1, \dots, 60\}$ (peaking at $|Q_{xy}| = 60$, $I_1 = 110 < I_2 = 230 < I_3 = 340$, on Group VI squares #46, #71, #253, and #286), and undergo unstable Dzhanibekov flips about $y = -\operatorname{sgn}(Q_{xy})\, x$ at dimensionless exponential growth rate

$$\Gamma(S) = \sqrt{\frac{(I_2 - I_1)(I_3 - I_2)}{I_1 I_3}} = \sqrt{\frac{|Q_{xy}(S)|}{I_0}} = \sqrt{\frac{|Q_{xy}(S)|}{170}}.$$

3. (3D lifted entry-weighted gem and unification with $\mathbf{V}_3(S;\lambda)$.) *When the entry masses $m_{ij} = s_{ij}$ are placed at the 3D lifted points $\mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda) = (x_j, y_i, \lambda z_{ij})$ ($\lambda > 0$), the centre of mass shifts vertically to $\mathbf{c}^{(s)}(\lambda) = (0, 0, z_{\mathrm{cm}}(\lambda))$ with $z_{\mathrm{cm}}(\lambda) = \lambda b_n/\bar{s} = \frac{\lambda(n^2-1)}{6}$ ($= \frac{5}{2}\lambda$ at $n = 4$). Because $\sum_{i,j} z_{ij}^3 = 0$, the diagonal moments of inertia about O are $I^{(s)}_{xx,O}(\lambda) = I^{(s)}_{yy,O}(\lambda) = M(a_n + \lambda^2 b_n)$ and $I^{(s)}_{zz,O}(\lambda) = 2I_0$, matching the equal-mass gem in Theorem 3.1(1). Translating to the true centre of mass $\mathbf{c}^{(s)}(\lambda)$ via Steiner's parallel-axis theorem leaves $I^{(s)}_{zz,\mathrm{cm}} = 2I_0$ and all off-diagonal products unchanged while subtracting $Mz_{\mathrm{cm}}(\lambda)^2$ from the horizontal diagonal moments:*

$$I^{(s)}_{xx,\mathrm{cm}}(\lambda) = I^{(s)}_{yy,\mathrm{cm}}(\lambda) = M\left(a_n + \lambda^2 b_n\left(1 - \frac{b_n}{\bar{s}^2}\right)\right) = Ma_n\left(1 + \frac{2(n^2+2)}{3}\lambda^2\right)$$

($= 170(1 + 12\lambda^2)$ at $n = 4$). In both frames (O and $\mathbf{c}^{(s)}(\lambda)$), the off-diagonal products of inertia are $I^{(s)}_{xy} = -Q_{xy}(S)$ and

$$\left(I^{(s)}_{xz}(\lambda),\, I^{(s)}_{yz}(\lambda)\right) = -\lambda \sum_{i,j} z_{ij}^2 (x_j, y_i) = -\lambda^{-1}\Big(\big(\mathbf{V}_3(S;\lambda)\big)_x,\, \big(\mathbf{V}_3(S;\lambda)\big)_y\Big).$$

Consequently, an order-four magic square has a diagonal, axisymmetric 3D entry-weighted inertia tensor if and only if it is one of the 48 associative squares ($Q_{xy} = 0$ and $\mathbf{V}_3 = \mathbf{0}$).

Proof. (1)–(2) Since every row excess $R_i = \sum_j z_{ij}$ and column excess $C_j = \sum_i z_{ij}$ vanishes, $\sum_{i,j} s_{ij}x_j^2 = \bar{s}\sum_{i,j} x_j^2 + \sum_j x_j^2 C_j = Ma_n = I_0$ and $\sum_{i,j} s_{ij}y_i^2 = I_0$, giving $I_{xx} = I_{yy} = I_0$ and $I_{zz} = 2I_0$. Since $\sum_{i,j} x_j y_i = 0$, $I_{xy} = -\sum_{i,j} s_{ij}x_j y_i = -Q_{xy}(S)$. Diagonalizing $\left(\begin{smallmatrix} I_0 & -Q_{xy} \\ -Q_{xy} & I_0 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ yields eigenvalues $I_0 \mp |Q_{xy}|$ along $(1, \pm 1)/\sqrt{2}$, proving (21)–(22). At $n = 4$, $I_0 = 170$, $|Q_{xy}| \le 60 < 170$, and $I_3 - I_2 = 2I_0 - (I_0 + |Q_{xy}|) = I_1$ simplifies $\sqrt{(I_2 - I_1)(I_3 - I_2)/(I_1 I_3)}$ to $\sqrt{|Q_{xy}|/I_0}$.

(3) At $\mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda)$, $\sum_{i,j} s_{ij}(x_j, y_i) = \mathbf{0}$ while $\sum_{i,j}(\bar{s} + z_{ij})\lambda z_{ij} = \lambda \sum_{i,j} z_{ij}^2 = N\lambda b_n$, giving $z_{\mathrm{cm}}(\lambda) = \lambda b_n/\bar{s}$. Since $\sum_{i,j} z_{ij}^3 = 0$, $\sum_{i,j}(\bar{s} + z_{ij})\lambda^2 z_{ij}^2 = M\lambda^2 b_n$, so $I^{(s)}_{xx,O}(\lambda) = I^{(s)}_{yy,O}(\lambda) = M(a_n + \lambda^2 b_n)$. Steiner's theorem subtracts $Mz_{\mathrm{cm}}(\lambda)^2 \operatorname{diag}(1, 1, 0)$, and $1 - b_n/\bar{s}^2 = \frac{2(n^2+2)}{3(n^2+1)}$ gives $b_n(1 - b_n/\bar{s}^2) = \frac{2(n^2+2)}{3} a_n$. Finally, $I^{(s)}_{xz}(\lambda) = -\lambda \sum_{i,j} z_{ij}^2 x_j = -\lambda^{-1}(\mathbf{V}_3)_x$ and similarly for $I^{(s)}_{yz}(\lambda)$, both of which vanish alongside $Q_{xy}(S)$ on all 48 associative squares by Theorem 2.5(1). □

3.3 From Point Clouds to Continuous Polyhedra: Why Solid Hulls Tilt on the Pivot

What happens to rotational stability when we replace the discrete point cloud P_S by the uniform-density 3D solid polyhedron $\mathcal{G}_0(S) = \operatorname{conv} P_S$? Decomposing $\mathcal{G}_0(S)$ into exact rational tetrahedra (Section A) shows that about its own centre of mass $\mathbf{c}_0(S)$, the solid inertia tensor remains remarkably close to the axisymmetric point-mass rotor of Theorem 3.1: across all 880 squares at $\lambda = 1$, the ratio of the mean transverse moment $\frac{1}{2}(I_2 + I_3)$ to the axial moment I_1 averages 9.41 (range [7.34, 11.57], tracking the point-mass value 9), and the relative transverse splitting remains below 2.5% ($\frac{I_3 - I_2}{I_2} \in [0.00004, 0.0243]$, mean 0.0071).

Yet when we place the cast solid $\mathcal{G}_0(S)$ on our pivot at the grid origin O under gravity, a more basic failure occurs: on 829 of the 880 squares, taking the convex hull shifts the solid centre of mass $\mathbf{c}_0(S)$ off the origin ($\mathbf{c}_0(S) \neq \mathbf{0}$), so gravity immediately exerts a tipping torque $\boldsymbol{\tau}_{\text{grav}} = M\mathbf{c}_0(S) \times \mathbf{g} \neq \mathbf{0}$. Understanding why the convex hull breaks centroid balance—and how the interior points of the magic square restore it—is the subject of Test 3.

4 Test 3: Convex Hulls and "Diamond-in-a-Diamond" Counterweighting

Why does passing from the discrete point cloud P_S ($\sum_{i,j} \mathbf{p}_{ij} = \mathbf{0}$) to its uniform-density solid convex hull $\mathcal{G}_0(S) := \mathcal{G}(S) = \operatorname{conv} P_S$ shift the solid centre of mass

$$\mathbf{c}_0(S) := \mathbf{c}_{\text{solid}}(\mathcal{G}_0(S)) = \frac{1}{\operatorname{vol} \mathcal{G}_0(S)} \iiint_{\mathcal{G}_0(S)} \mathbf{x}\, dV$$

away from the origin O on 829 of the 880 order-four magic squares? Taking the 3D convex hull introduces two geometric inequalities:

1. *Omission of interior points:* The boundary $\partial\mathcal{G}_0(S)$ depends solely on the $V_0 = |\operatorname{vert} \mathcal{G}_0(S)|$ extreme vertices and ignores the $V_1 = N - V_0$ interior and non-vertex points $P_S^{(1)} = P_S \setminus \operatorname{vert} \mathcal{G}_0(S)$.

2. *Volumetric simplex weighting:* Even when $V_0 = N = 16$ (18 of the 880 squares), decomposing $\mathcal{G}_0(S)$ into tetrahedra from O weights each simplex Δ_k by its volume $\operatorname{vol}(\Delta_k)$ rather than weighting the 16 vertices equally.

Test 3 asks: *since the outer hull vertices and the discarded inner points together sum to zero, their centroids must pull in strictly opposite directions across O. Can we restore exact balance at O by physically re-engaging the inner core $\mathcal{G}_1(S) = \operatorname{conv} P_S^{(1)}$ across cast solids, 3D-printed wireframes, complete strut networks, and folded papercraft shells?*

4.1 The 51 Naturally Balanced Solids and Outer–Inner Vertex Opposition

We first classify the 51 order-four magic squares whose uniform solid hull $\mathcal{G}_0(S)$ balances at O without any counterweight, and then prove the outer–inner opposition law for the remaining 829 squares.

Proposition 4.1 (Classification of the 51 naturally balanced order-four gems)**.** *Across the* 880 *magic squares of order* 4*, the uniform solid $\mathcal{G}_0(S)$ has centre of mass $\mathbf{c}_0(S) = \mathbf{0}$ for* 51 *squares:*

1. *The* 48 *associative squares (Dudeney's Group III), for which $z(-x, -y) = -z(x, y)$ implies $\mathcal{G}_0(S) = -\mathcal{G}_0(S)$, forcing $\mathbf{c}_0(S) = -\mathbf{c}_0(S) = \mathbf{0}$ by central inversion.*

2. *Three non-associative squares in Dudeney's Group VI: squares #86, #739, and #756 (Table 1).*

Proof. For every associative square S, $P_S = -P_S$ implies $\mathcal{G}_0(S) = -\mathcal{G}_0(S)$ and $\mathbf{c}_0(S) = \mathbf{0}$. Each of the three Group VI squares #86, #739, and #756 satisfies $\overline{S} = hS$ or $\overline{S} = vS$, so $\mathcal{G}_0(S)$ is invariant under a 180° half-turn $\iota_h\colon (x, y, z) \mapsto (x, -y, -z)$ or $\iota_v\colon (x, y, z) \mapsto (-x, y, -z)$ in $\mathbb{R}^3$ [13, Prop. 4.3]. The half-turn forces two coordinates of $\mathbf{c}_0(S)$ to vanish identically, and exact simplicial integration (Section A) certifies that the single remaining rational axial moment vanishes exclusively on #86, #739, and #756 among all 832 non-associative squares. □

Table 1: The three non-associative order-four magic squares whose uniform solid $\mathcal{G}_0(S)$ has exact centre of mass $\mathbf{c}_0(S) = \mathbf{0}$, together with their inner core $\mathcal{G}_1(S) = \mathrm{conv}(P_S \setminus \mathrm{vert}\,\mathcal{G}_0(S))$. All three squares lie in Dudeney's Group VI and have 12 outer vertices and 4 inner points (spanning a planar parallelogram in #86 and a 3D tetrahedron in #739 and #756) whose centroid $\mathbf{c}_1(S)$ is also $\mathbf{0}$.

Square	Dudeney	$f(\mathcal{G}_0)$	$\mathrm{vol}(\mathcal{G}_0)$	$\mathrm{Iso}(\mathcal{G}_0)$	$\dim$ / $\mathrm{vol}(\mathcal{G}_1)$	First row of standard form S
#86	Group VI	$(12, 28, 18)$	209/3	C_2 $(\overline{S} = vS)$	2D (0)	$(1, 7, 14, 12)$
#739	Group VI	$(12, 26, 16)$	287/3	C_2 $(\overline{S} = hS)$	3D (5/3)	$(4, 14, 3, 13)$
#756	Group VI	$(12, 24, 14)$	84	C_2 $(\overline{S} = hS)$	3D (4/3)	$(5, 2, 15, 12)$

To counter the centroid drift on the remaining 829 squares, we peel P_S into nested convex layers [4]:

$$P_S^{(0)} = P_S, \qquad \mathcal{G}_k(S) = \mathrm{conv}\, P_S^{(k)}, \qquad P_S^{(k+1)} = P_S^{(k)} \setminus \mathrm{vert}\,\mathcal{G}_k(S) \quad (k \geq 0), \tag{23}$$

calling $\mathcal{G}_0(S)$ the *outer gem* and $\mathcal{G}_1(S) = \mathrm{conv}\, P_S^{(1)} \subset \mathcal{G}_0(S)$ the *inner core gem*—"a diamond inside a diamond" (Figure 5(a,b)).

Proposition 4.2 (Vertex-centroid opposition and order-four onion hierarchy)**.** *Let S be any arrangement of order n with $V_0 = |\mathrm{vert}\,\mathcal{G}_0(S)| < N$ and $V_1 = N - V_0$.*

1. (Exact vertex-centroid opposition.) *The centroid $\overline{\mathbf{p}}_{\mathrm{outer}} = \frac{1}{V_0}\sum_{\mathbf{p}\in\mathrm{vert}\,\mathcal{G}_0} \mathbf{p}$ of the outer hull vertices and the centroid $\overline{\mathbf{p}}_{\mathrm{inner}} = \frac{1}{V_1}\sum_{\mathbf{p}\in P_S^{(1)}} \mathbf{p}$ of the inner core points satisfy*

$$V_0\,\overline{\mathbf{p}}_{\mathrm{outer}} + V_1\,\overline{\mathbf{p}}_{\mathrm{inner}} = \mathbf{0}, \tag{24}$$

   pointing in strictly opposite directions across O whenever $\overline{\mathbf{p}}_{\mathrm{outer}} \neq \mathbf{0}$.

2. (Order-four layer census.) *Across the* 880 *magic squares of order* 4 *(Figure 5(c)):* 18 *squares have $V_0 = 16$ ($P_S^{(1)} = \emptyset$);* 842 *squares have onion depth* 2 *(*14 *singletons,* 162 *segments,* 175 *planar polygons, and* 491 *3D polyhedra $\mathcal{G}_1(S)$); and* 20 *squares have onion depth* 3 *($\mathcal{G}_0 \supset \mathcal{G}_1 \supset \mathcal{G}_2$, comprising* 16 *with dimension sequence* $(3, 3, 0)$ *and* 4 *with* $(3, 3, 1)$*). In total,* 511 *order-four magic squares possess a three-dimensional inner core gem $\mathcal{G}_1(S)$.*

Proof. Equation (24) follows immediately from $\sum_{\mathbf{p}\in P_S} \mathbf{p} = \mathbf{0}$ and $P_S = \mathrm{vert}\,\mathcal{G}_0(S) \sqcup P_S^{(1)}$, and exact convex-hull peeling across all 880 squares yields (2). □

4.2 Restoring Solid Balance via "Diamond-in-a-Diamond" Core Inclusions

Guided by the opposition identity (24), our first restoration method plays the inner core $\mathcal{G}_1(S)$ directly against the outer solid hull $\mathcal{G}_0(S)$. For a two-density composite solid to balance via a single scalar density increment $\Delta\rho_1$, the 3D vectors $\mathbf{c}_0(S)$ and $\mathbf{c}_1(S)$ must be collinear—which occurs in Dudeney's Group VI, where C_2 half-turn symmetry locks both centroids onto the same coordinate axis.

Theorem 4.3 (Composite "diamond-in-a-diamond" solid balancing)**.** *Let S be an order-four magic square.*

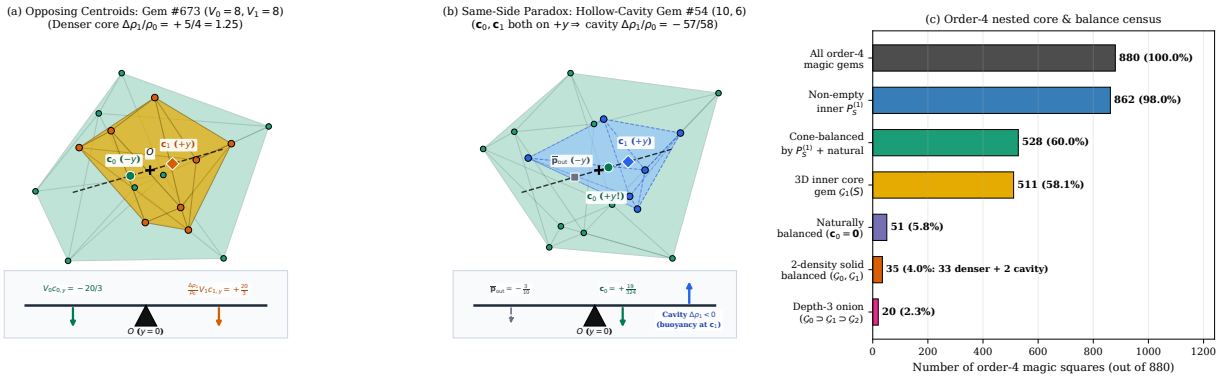


Figure 5: Nested "diamond-in-a-diamond" convex layers $\mathcal{G}_0(S) \supset \mathcal{G}_1(S)$ and centre-of-mass restoration. (a) Denser-core Gem #673 ($(V_0, V_1) = (8, 8)$, Figure 1(e)) and (b) hollow-cavity Gem #54 ($(V_0, V_1) = (10, 6)$, 1-swap sibling of #45 in Figure 1(c)), showing the translucent outer hull $\mathcal{G}_0(S)$ enclosing the inner core gem $\mathcal{G}_1(S)$ alongside 2D fulcrum lever diagrams at bottom. On #673, $\mathbf{c}_0 = (0, 0, -20/257)$ (green circle) and $\mathbf{c}_1 = (0, 0, +2/7)$ (gold diamond) lie on opposite sides of O, balancing via a heavier inner core ($\Delta\rho_1/\rho_0 = +5/4$, $\rho_1/\rho_0 = 2.25$). On #54, although the discrete outer vertices still pull to $-y$ ($\overline{\mathbf{p}}_{\text{outer}} = (0, -3/10, 0)$), volumetric simplex weighting pulls $\mathbf{c}_0 = (0, +19/324, 0)$ onto the $+y$ side alongside $\mathbf{c}_1 = (0, +29/68, 0)$, so subtracting a 98.3% hollow core cavity ($\Delta\rho_1/\rho_0 = -57/58$, $\rho_1/\rho_0 = 1/58$) restores balance at O. (c) Breakdown of nested layer properties and balance mechanisms across all 880 order-four magic squares.

1. (Two-density solid inclusion $(\mathcal{G}_0, \mathcal{G}_1)$.) *Suppose* $\dim \mathcal{G}_1(S) = 3$ *(511 squares), and fabricate* $\mathcal{G}_0(S)$ *with baseline density* $\rho_0 > 0$ *and inner core inclusion* $\mathcal{G}_1(S) \subset \mathcal{G}_0(S)$ *of excess density* $\Delta\rho_1 = \rho_1 - \rho_0$. *The composite centre of mass*

$$\mathbf{c}_{\text{comp}} = \frac{\rho_0 \operatorname{vol}(\mathcal{G}_0)\, \mathbf{c}_0 + \Delta\rho_1 \operatorname{vol}(\mathcal{G}_1)\, \mathbf{c}_1}{\rho_0 \operatorname{vol}(\mathcal{G}_0) + \Delta\rho_1 \operatorname{vol}(\mathcal{G}_1)}$$

vanishes for some $\Delta\rho_1 \neq 0$ *if and only if* $\mathbf{c}_0$ *and* $\mathbf{c}_1$ *are non-zero and collinear* ($\mathbf{c}_0 \times \mathbf{c}_1 = \mathbf{0}$), *with unique balancing density increment*

$$\frac{\Delta\rho_1}{\rho_0} = -\frac{\operatorname{vol}(\mathcal{G}_0)\,(\mathbf{c}_0 \cdot \mathbf{c}_1)}{\operatorname{vol}(\mathcal{G}_1)\,\|\mathbf{c}_1\|_2^2}. \tag{25}$$

The 511 *order-four gems with* $\dim \mathcal{G}_1(S) = 3$ *partition into four classes:*

- 207 *gems have* $\mathbf{c}_1 = \mathbf{0}$ *(*13 *associative gems plus* 194 *non-associative gems whose four inner points form a zero-sum tetrahedron);*
- 254 *gems (outside Group VI) have non-collinear solid centroids* $\mathbf{c}_0 \times \mathbf{c}_1 \neq \mathbf{0}$*;*
- 33 *Group VI gems have strictly anti-parallel solid centroids* ($\mathbf{c}_0 \cdot \mathbf{c}_1 < 0$), *balanced by a* denser *inner core with rational excess density* $\Delta\rho_1/\rho_0 \in [5/4,\ 191/6]$ *(Table 2 and Table 5), led by Gem #673 at* $\Delta\rho_1/\rho_0 = 5/4$ *(Figure 1(e), Figure 5(a));*
- 17 *Group VI gems have parallel solid centroids pointing in the* same *direction* ($\mathbf{c}_0 \cdot \mathbf{c}_1 > 0$), *because volumetric simplex weighting pulls* $\mathbf{c}_0$ *onto the same side of* O *as* $\mathbf{c}_1$ *despite the opposite vertex centroids of* (24). *Balancing these gems requires* $\Delta\rho_1 < 0$, *which is physically realizable with non-negative core density* $\rho_1 \in [0, \rho_0)$ *for two gems: square #123* ($\Delta\rho_1/\rho_0 = -3/17$, $\rho_1/\rho_0 = 14/17$, *a lighter core) and square #54* ($\Delta\rho_1/\rho_0 = -57/58$, $\rho_1/\rho_0 = 1/58$, *a nearly hollow core cavity, Figure 5(b)). Square #54 differs from denser-core square #45* ($\Delta\rho_1/\rho_0 = +85/61$) *by a single border swap* $(8, 9) \leftrightarrow (15, 2)$ *(Figure 1(c)), which inflates the* $+y$ *hull flares enough to pull* $\mathbf{c}_0$ *across* O *from* $(0, -85/856, 0)$ *to* $(0, +19/324, 0)$.

2. (Non-negative inner-core point weighting.) *Placing non-negative point masses* $m_q \geq 0$ *at the inner points* $q \in P_S^{(1)}$ *balances the uniform solid* $\mathcal{G}_0(S)$ *at* O *if and only if* $-\mathbf{c}_0(S) \in$

$\mathrm{cone}(P_S^{(1)})$, *which holds for* 477 *of the* 829 *unbalanced gems (*$528/880 = 60.0\%$ *including the* 51 *naturally balanced solids).*

3. (Universal bead-inlaid solid.) *For* every *semi-magic square* S *of any order* n*, partitioning* $\mathcal{G}_0(S)$ *into* N *cells of equal mass* M/N *with centroids at* $\mathbf{p}_{ij}$ *(or embedding* N *identical dense beads at* $\mathbf{p}_{ij}$ *in a lightweight shell) yields* $\mathbf{c}_{\mathrm{comp}} = \mathbf{0}$ *and restores the axisymmetric inertia tensor of Theorem 3.1.*

Proof. Part (1) follows from setting $\rho_0 \operatorname{vol}(\mathcal{G}_0)\mathbf{c}_0 + \Delta\rho_1 \operatorname{vol}(\mathcal{G}_1)\mathbf{c}_1 = \mathbf{0}$ and evaluating the exact rational simplicial moments (Section A) across all 511 gems with $\dim \mathcal{G}_1(S) = 3$. Part (2) is certified by linear programming for $-\mathbf{c}_0 \in \mathrm{cone}(P_S^{(1)})$, and Part (3) follows from $\sum_{i,j} \mathbf{p}_{ij} = \mathbf{0}$ and Theorem 3.1. □

Table 2: The eight order-four Magic Gems with the smallest balancing excess density ratios $\Delta\rho_1/\rho_0 \in [5/4, 40/19] \approx [1.25, 2.11]$ in a two-density "diamond-in-a-diamond" solid inclusion $(\mathcal{G}_0(S), \mathcal{G}_1(S))$ (Theorem 4.3(1)), all achievable with standard dual-material 3D printing. All 33 denser-core gems belong to Dudeney's Group VI; the full list of 33 is given in Table 5.

1-idx	0-idx	(V_0, V_1)	$\operatorname{vol}(\mathcal{G}_0)$	$\operatorname{vol}(\mathcal{G}_1)$	Axial c_0	Axial c_1	Exact $\Delta\rho_1/\rho_0$	Decimal ρ_1/ρ_0
#673	672	(8, 8)	257/3	56/3	−20/257	+2/7	5/4	2.250
#502	501	(10, 6)	271/3	6	+2/271	−1/12	4/3	2.333
#45	44	(10, 6)	214/3	6	−85/856	+61/72	85/61	2.393
#50	49	(10, 6)	254/3	22/3	−7/127	+19/44	28/19	2.474
#307	306	(10, 6)	277/3	22/3	+23/1108	−15/88	23/15	2.533
#49	48	(12, 4)	81	2	−2/81	+1/2	2	3.000
#38	37	(10, 6)	263/3	22/3	+31/1052	−15/88	31/15	3.067
#47	46	(10, 6)	247/3	22/3	−20/247	+19/44	40/19	3.105

4.3 Overcoming the Density Barrier: Complete K_N Networks, Nested Wireframes, and Papercraft Shells

While the eight gems in Table 2 have modest excess density ratios $\Delta\rho_1/\rho_0 \in [5/4, 40/19]$ that print directly on a dual-extruder 3D printer (e.g. standard PLA around a tungsten- or bronze-filled PLA core), the remaining 25 denser-core gems in Table 5 have tiny core volumes $\operatorname{vol}(\mathcal{G}_1)$ requiring $\Delta\rho_1/\rho_0 \in [47/12, 191/6]$, and 194 gems have a 4-vertex tetrahedral core whose solid centroid $\mathbf{c}_{\mathrm{solid}}(\mathcal{G}_1) = \frac{1}{4}\sum \mathbf{p}_q = \mathbf{0}$ provides no lever arm at all.

Replacing solid volume with the skeletal and thin-shell architectures of `magicGemWeb` [12] (Figure 6) overcomes both barriers: (i) connecting all $\binom{N}{2}$ pairs of points as a complete strut network $K_N\big(P_S(\lambda)\big)$ (`magicGem_v2.stl`, Figure 6(b)) restores equal participation of all N vertices; (ii) building a nested ball-and-rod wireframe $G(\mathcal{G}_0) \cup G(\mathcal{G}_1)$ (`magicGem_v1.stl`, Figure 6(a)) replaces volumetric scaling with quadratic rod-diameter scaling ($\rho_{\mathrm{lin}} \propto d^2$) and gives 4-vertex tetrahedral cores a non-zero edge-length centroid $\mathbf{c}_{\mathrm{wire}}(\mathcal{G}_1) \neq \mathbf{0}$; and (iii) unfolding $\partial\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S)$ along a dual spanning tree produces a flat printable papercraft net (Figure 6(c)).

Theorem 4.4 (Complete K_N strut networks and two-gauge nested wireframes)**.** *Let* S *be an arrangement of* $\{1, \ldots, N\}$*,* $N = n^2$ *(*$n \geq 2$*), with* $\sum_{u=1}^{N} \mathbf{p}_u(\lambda) = \mathbf{0}$ *and empirical covariance matrix* $\Sigma(\lambda) = \frac{1}{N}\sum_{u=1}^{N} \mathbf{p}_u(\lambda)\mathbf{p}_u(\lambda)^\top$*. In the slender-rod limit* $d/L_{uv} \to 0^+$*:*

1. (Equal-mass-per-edge complete network K_N.) *If each of the* $\binom{N}{2}$ *rods connecting* $\mathbf{p}_u(\lambda)$ *and* $\mathbf{p}_v(\lambda)$ *(*$1 \leq u < v \leq N$*) carries equal mass* $m_{\mathrm{edge}} = M_{\mathrm{rods}}/\binom{N}{2}$ *(with optional equal node masses* $m_{\mathrm{node}} = M_{\mathrm{nodes}}/N$*), then* $(N-1)$*-regularity of* K_N *places the centre of mass at* O *for* every *arrangement* S*:*

$$\mathbf{c}\big(K_N(\lambda)\big) = \frac{1}{\binom{N}{2}} \sum_{1 \leq u < v \leq N} \frac{\mathbf{p}_u(\lambda) + \mathbf{p}_v(\lambda)}{2} = \frac{1}{N}\sum_{u=1}^{N} \mathbf{p}_u(\lambda) = \mathbf{0}, \tag{26}$$

and the continuous second-moment covariance matrix of the $\binom{N}{2}$ *rods is a universal scalar multiple of* $\Sigma(\lambda)$*:*

$$\Sigma_{\text{rods}}^{(=mass)}\big(K_N(\lambda)\big) = \frac{2N-3}{3(N-1)}\,\Sigma(\lambda) \qquad \Big(= \frac{5}{8}\,\Sigma(\lambda) \text{ at } n=3, \quad \frac{29}{45}\,\Sigma(\lambda) \text{ at } n=4\Big). \tag{27}$$

Consequently, for every semi-magic square S*, the equal-mass complete network* $K_N\big(P_S(\lambda)\big)$ *shares the exact same axisymmetric inertia ratio* $I_\perp(\lambda)/I_{zz} = \frac{1}{2}\big(1+\lambda^2(n^2+1)\big)$ *and spherical-top scale* $\lambda_{\text{iso}} = (n^2+1)^{-1/2}$ *as the discrete point cloud in Theorem 3.1.*

2. (Uniform-diameter strut networks $\rho_{\text{lin}} = \text{const.}$) *When a subgraph* $G = (V_G, E_G)$ *is printed with uniform rod diameter* d*, each rod has mass proportional to its length* $L_{uv}(\lambda) = \|\mathbf{p}_u(\lambda) - \mathbf{p}_v(\lambda)\|_2$*. Across all* 880 *order-four magic squares (Figure 6(d)), both* K_{16} *and the outer wireframe* $G(\mathcal{G}_0)$ *have* $\mathbf{c}_{\text{len}} = \mathbf{0}$ *if and only if* S *is one of the* 48 *associative squares, but passing from* $G(\mathcal{G}_0)$ *to the* 120*-rod complete network* K_{16} *reduces mean centroid drift* $\|\mathbf{c}_{\text{len}}\|_2$ *by* $2.7\times$ *at* $\lambda = 1$ *(from* 0.194 *to* 0.072*) and by* $3.6\times$ *at* $\lambda = 0.20$ *(from* 0.088 *to* 0.025*).*

3. (Single-material balance of nested wireframes $G(\mathcal{G}_0) \cup G(\mathcal{G}_1)$ via rod diameter tuning.) *For the* 848 *order-four gems with* $\dim \mathcal{G}_1(S) \geq 1$*, printing the outer edges* $E(\mathcal{G}_0)$ *with rod diameter* d_0 *and the disjoint inner core edges* $E(\mathcal{G}_1)$ *with rod diameter* d_1 *restores* $\mathbf{c}_{\text{wire}}(\mathcal{G}_0 \cup \mathcal{G}_1) = \mathbf{0}$ *whenever* $\mathbf{c}_{\text{wire}}(\mathcal{G}_0)$ *and* $\mathbf{c}_{\text{wire}}(\mathcal{G}_1)$ *are strictly anti-parallel, at the unique rod diameter ratio*

$$\frac{d_1}{d_0} = \sqrt{\frac{\rho_{\text{lin},1}}{\rho_{\text{lin},0}}} = \sqrt{-\frac{L\big(G(\mathcal{G}_0)\big)\,\big(\mathbf{c}_{\text{wire}}(\mathcal{G}_0)\cdot\mathbf{c}_{\text{wire}}(\mathcal{G}_1)\big)}{L\big(G(\mathcal{G}_1)\big)\,\|\mathbf{c}_{\text{wire}}(\mathcal{G}_1)\|_2^2}}. \tag{28}$$

This balances 158 *Group VI gems at* $\lambda = 1$ *(e.g. Gem #673 at* $d_1/d_0 = 0.793$ *and Gem #45 at* $d_1/d_0 = 0.795$*) and* 164 *Group VI gems at* $\lambda = 0.20$*.*

Proof. (1) Integrating $\mathbf{x}(t) = (1-t)\mathbf{p}_u + t\mathbf{p}_v$ over $t \in [0,1]$ gives midpoint $\frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{p}_u + \mathbf{p}_v)$ and second moment $\frac{1}{3}(\mathbf{p}_u\mathbf{p}_u^\top + \mathbf{p}_v\mathbf{p}_v^\top) + \frac{1}{6}(\mathbf{p}_u\mathbf{p}_v^\top + \mathbf{p}_v\mathbf{p}_u^\top)$. Since each vertex belongs to $N-1$ edges of K_N and $\sum_{u<v}(\mathbf{p}_u\mathbf{p}_v^\top + \mathbf{p}_v\mathbf{p}_u^\top) = -N\Sigma(\lambda)$, averaging over $\binom{N}{2}$ edges yields (26)–(27). Parts (2)–(3) follow by exact evaluation across all 880 squares (Section A). □

Proposition 4.5 (Papercraft cutout nets, glue-tab invariant, and nested thin-shell balance)**.** *Let* $\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S)$ *be any three-dimensional Magic Gem with* f*-vector* (f_0, f_1, f_2)*.*

1. (Topological glue-tab invariant $N_{\text{tabs}} = f_0 - 1$ and non-overlapping nets.) *Unfolding* $\partial\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S)$ *into a connected planar net along any spanning tree* T^* *of the dual facet graph* $G^*(\mathcal{G})$ *[7, 18, 5, 9] partitions the* f_1 *edges into* $f_2 - 1$ *interior fold creases and* $N_{\text{tabs}} = f_1 - (f_2 - 1)$ *cut edges joined by trapezoidal glue tabs (paired by labels* **a**–**k** *in Figure 6(c)). Because* $\partial\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S) \cong S^2$*, the cut edges* $E \setminus E(T^*)$ *form a spanning tree* T *of the primal* 1*-skeleton* $G(\mathcal{G}_\lambda)$ *on the* f_0 *hull vertices, so the number of glue tabs depends* solely on the hull vertex count f_0*:*

$$N_{\text{tabs}} = f_1 - (f_2 - 1) = |E(T)| = f_0 - 1, \tag{29}$$

taking every integer value in $\{7, \ldots, 15\}$ *across* $\mathcal{M}_4$ *(*11 *tabs for Dürer's #175). Under the deterministic breadth-first dual spanning tree* T^* *rooted at the largest-area facet* F_0 *(*★F_0 *in Figure 6(c))*, all 880 order-four Magic Gems (100%) unfold into strictly non-overlapping 2D planar nets *at both* $\lambda = 1$ *and* $\lambda = 0.20$*.*

2. (Hollow thin-shell balance.) *A uniform boundary shell* $\partial\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S)$ *of areal density* $\sigma_0 > 0$ *has* $\mathbf{c}_{\text{shell}}(\mathcal{G}_0) = \mathbf{0}$ *on the* 48 *associative squares, and enclosing a nested inner shell* $\partial\mathcal{G}_1(S)$ *(*$\dim \mathcal{G}_1 = 3$*) of areal density* σ_1 *restores* $\mathbf{c}_{\text{shell}}(\partial\mathcal{G}_0 \cup \partial\mathcal{G}_1) = \mathbf{0}$ *for* 80 *Group VI gems at* $\lambda = 1$ *(*87 *at* $\lambda = 0.20$*).*

Proof. By planar graph duality on $\partial\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S) \cong S^2$, the complement of a dual spanning tree $T^* \subset G^*(\mathcal{G}_\lambda)$ ($|E(T^*)| = f_2 - 1$) is a primal spanning tree $T \subset G(\mathcal{G}_\lambda)$ on the f_0 vertices, giving $N_{\text{tabs}} = |E(T)| = f_0 - 1$ (invariant under facet triangulation). Exact 2D polygon intersection testing and triangular surface moments certify non-overlap and the shell censuses across all 880 gems (Section A). □

Remark 4.6 (Physical realization of finite-diameter struts and core suspension). In a physical 3D print of finite rod diameter $d > 0$, each cylindrical strut of length L_{uv} and direction $\hat{\mathbf{e}}_{uv}$ retains midpoint centroid $\frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{p}_u + \mathbf{p}_v)$ and adds the radial inertia correction $m_{uv}\frac{d^2}{16}(I_3 + \hat{\mathbf{e}}_{uv}\hat{\mathbf{e}}_{uv}^\top)$ up to $O(d^3)$ hub-overlap volumes. Suspending the inner core wireframe $G(\mathcal{G}_1)$ inside $G(\mathcal{G}_0)$ on a Group VI gem via C_2-symmetric pairs of equal-length struts places the suspension centroid at O, leaving the balancing diameter ratio d_1/d_0 in (28) invariant.

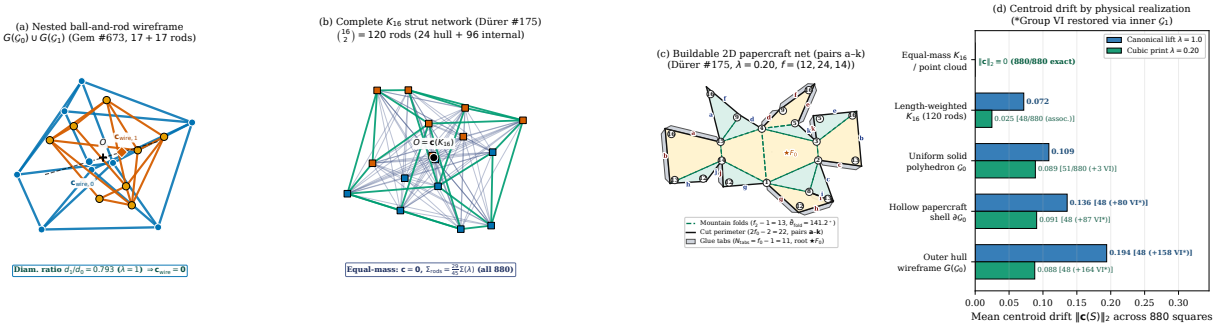


Figure 6: Wireframes, complete K_{16} strut networks, and unfolded papercraft cutout nets of Magic Gems [12]. (a) Nested ball-and-rod wireframe $G(\mathcal{G}_0) \cup G(\mathcal{G}_1)$ of Gem #673 (17 outer blue rods + 17 inner orange rods), where tuning the inner-to-outer rod diameter ratio to $d_1/d_0 = 0.793$ at $\lambda = 1$ (0.493 at $\lambda = 0.20$) restores $\mathbf{c}_{\text{wire}} = \mathbf{0}$. (b) Fully interconnected complete network K_{16} of Dürer's Gem #175 (`magicGem_v2.stl`) with all $\binom{16}{2} = 120$ rods (24 outer hull edges in green + 96 internal cross-struts in slate) and 16 node cubes; for equal-mass rods, $\mathbf{c}(K_{16}) = \mathbf{0}$ and $\Sigma_{\text{rods}} = \frac{29}{45}\Sigma(\lambda)$ for all 880 squares (Theorem 4.4(1)). (c) Exact 2D unfolded papercraft cutout net of Dürer's Gem #175 ($\lambda = 0.20$, $f = (12, 24, 14)$) rooted at $\bigstar F_0$, with $f_2 - 1 = 13$ dashed fold lines (mean dihedral fold angle $\overline{\theta}_{\text{fold}} = 141.2° \in [117°, 165°]$), $2f_0 - 2 = 22$ solid cut perimeter segments, $N_{\text{tabs}} = f_0 - 1 = 11$ grey trapezoidal glue tabs paired with their mating cut edges by lowercase labels `a`–`k` (Proposition 4.5(1)), and magic entries s_{ij} at the unfolded vertices. (d) Comparison of mean centroid drift $\|\mathbf{c}(S)\|_2$ across all 880 order-four magic squares for the five physical realizations at $\lambda = 1.0$ and $\lambda = 0.20$.

Having restored internal balance to individual polyhedra, we now remove the central pivot O in Test 4 and place Magic Gems directly on a flat horizontal table and into multi-block vertical stacks under gravity.

5 Test 4: Freestanding Gravity and Mirror-Twin Towers

Our fourth and final test removes the central pivot and places Magic Gems directly onto a flat horizontal table under gravity—first as individual resting blocks, and then stacked face-to-face into multi-block vertical columns. Because the hull vertices sit at unequal heights, the boundary facets of $\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S)$ are slanted polygons whose outward normals rarely oppose each other across the gem. Test 4 asks: *(i) when does a slanted facet $F \subset \partial\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S)$ support the gem's centre of mass without tipping, and (ii) when identical copies of a gem curve off-axis along mismatched top and bottom facets, how does pairing the gem with an inverted partner restore a straight vertical column?*

5.1 Single-Block Table Equilibrium: Cubic Aspect Scaling Stabilizes 74.5% of Facets

Let $F \subset \partial\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S)$ be a facet with outward unit normal $\hat{\mathbf{n}}_F(\lambda)$. When $\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S)$ rests with F on a horizontal table (so $\hat{\mathbf{n}}_F(\lambda)$ points straight down), gravity acts vertically through the centre of mass

$\mathbf{c}(\lambda)$. Let $\pi_F(\mathbf{c}(\lambda))$ denote the orthogonal projection of $\mathbf{c}(\lambda)$ onto the affine plane of F, and let $h_F(\lambda) = (\mathbf{p}_F - \mathbf{c}(\lambda)) \cdot (-\hat{\mathbf{n}}_F(\lambda)) > 0$ be the height of the centre of mass above the table.

Definition 5.1 (Static stability margin and critical tipping angle)**.** For a facet $F \subset \partial\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S)$, the *stability margin* $d_{\text{stab}}(S, F; \lambda)$ is the signed Euclidean distance in the plane of F from $\pi_F(\mathbf{c}(\lambda))$ to the boundary ∂F of the facet polygon (positive when $\pi_F(\mathbf{c}(\lambda))$ lies in the strict relative interior of F, and negative outside). Facet F is *statically stable* if and only if $d_{\text{stab}}(S, F; \lambda) > 0$, with *critical tipping angle*

$$\theta_{\text{tip}}(S, F; \lambda) = \arctan\left(\frac{d_{\text{stab}}(S, F; \lambda)}{h_F(\lambda)}\right). \tag{30}$$

Proposition 5.2 (Order-four resting stability census)**.** *Across all* 880 *magic squares of order* 4*, the gems* $\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S)$ *possess a total of* 14,824 *facets (mean* 16.85 *facets per gem).*

1. *At the tall canonical lift* $\lambda = 1$ *(where the vertical height span* 15 *is five times the* 3×3 *floor span), the high centre of mass* $\mathbf{c}_0(S)$ *projects outside* 57.0% *of all facet polygons:* 6,378 *of the* 14,824 *facets* (43.0%) *are statically stable, with every gem possessing between* 4 *and* 12 *stable resting facets (mean* 7.25*; using the balanced point centroid* O *gives* 6,340 *stable facets,* 42.8%*).*

2. *Compressing the vertical lift to the cubic 3D-print scale* $\lambda_{\text{cube}} = 1/5 = 0.20$ *brings the centre of mass closer to the slanted upper and lower facets:* 11,044 *of the* 14,824 *facets* (74.5%) *become statically stable, with a mean critical tipping angle of* 17.8° *and a maximum of* 47.3° *(Figure 7(d)).*

Proof. For each facet $F \subset \partial\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S)$ with exact integer plane equation $aX + bY + cZ + d = 0$ in doubled coordinates, rescaling $z \mapsto \lambda z$ transforms the outward normal to $\mathbf{n}_F(\lambda) \propto (a\lambda, b\lambda, c)$ and the solid centroid to $\mathbf{c}_0(\lambda) = (c_{0,x}, c_{0,y}, \lambda c_{0,z})$. Projecting $\mathbf{c}_0(\lambda)$ onto the plane of F and evaluating $d_{\text{stab}}(S, F; \lambda)$ and (30) across all 14,824 facets yields the stated counts and angles. □

5.2 Why Same-Gem Stacks Wedge Apart, and How Mirror-Twin Inversion Restores Verticality

Suppose we now stack multiple blocks vertically along an upper facet $F_+ \subset \mathcal{G}_\lambda(S)$ (outward normal $+\mathbf{n}_+$, $n_{+,z} > 0$) and a lower facet $F_- \subset \mathcal{G}_\lambda(S)$ (outward normal $+\mathbf{n}_-$, $n_{-,z} < 0$). Stacking translated copies of the *same* gem $\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S)$ without rotation requires parallel opposite normals $\mathbf{n}_- = -\mathbf{n}_+$, which fails on 756 of the 880 gems (85.9%); when $\mathbf{n}_- \neq -\mathbf{n}_+$, identical copies meet at an open wedge angle that bends the column away from the vertical (Figure 7(c), left).

Equilibrium is restored by pairing a gem with its *rotational complement (mirror twin)*

$$S^* := r^2\overline{S} = (N+1)\mathbf{1} - r^2 S, \tag{31}$$

which inverts the polyhedron through the origin in $\mathbb{R}^3$ and pairs every slanted upper facet with an equal and opposite lower facet (Figure 7(a,c)).

Theorem 5.3 (Mirror-Twin Inversion and Zero-Rotation Alternating Towers)**.** *Let* S *be any arrangement of order* n*, let* $S^* = r^2\overline{S}$ *be its half-turned complement, and let* $\lambda > 0$*.*

1. (Central inversion identity.) *In* $\mathbb{R}^3$*, the lifted point clouds and convex hulls satisfy*

$$P_{S^*}(\lambda) = -P_S(\lambda), \qquad \mathcal{G}_\lambda(S^*) = -\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S). \tag{32}$$

Consequently, the map $F \mapsto F^* := -F$ *is an area-preserving, normal-reversing bijection between the upper facets* $F_+ \subset \mathcal{G}_\lambda(S)$ *(outward normal* $+\mathbf{n}_+$*) and the lower facets* $F_+^* \subset \mathcal{G}_\lambda(S^*)$ *(outward normal* $-\mathbf{n}_+$*), and between the lower facets* $F_- \subset \mathcal{G}_\lambda(S)$ *(outward normal* $+\mathbf{n}_-$*) and the upper facets* $F_-^* = -F_- \subset \mathcal{G}_\lambda(S^*)$ *(outward normal* $-\mathbf{n}_-$*).*

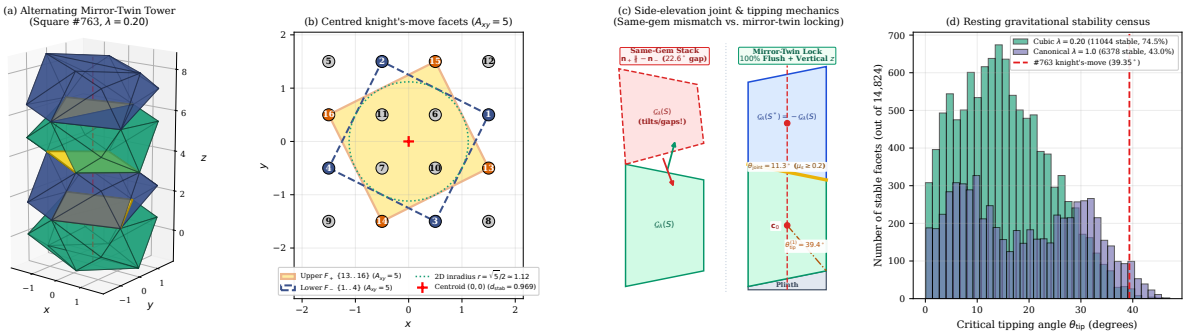


Figure 7: Mirror-twin facet locking and periodic vertical towers. (a) Four-block alternating tower of square #763 at the cubic 3D-print scale $\lambda = 0.20$, alternating $\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S)$ (green) with its mirror twin $\mathcal{G}_\lambda(r^2\overline{S}) = -\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S)$ (blue); the golden contact joints are the centred knight's-move squares $\{13, 14, 15, 16\}$ and $\{1, 2, 3, 4\}$, which meet with 100% vertex congruence and keep the column's centre of mass on the vertical z-axis (red dashed). (b) Top-down (x, y) footprint of square #763 showing the dual knight's-move squares of area $A_{xy} = 5$ and 2D footprint inradius $r = \sqrt{5}/2 \approx 1.12$ (while the 3D tilted-plane stability margin from $\mathbf{c}_0$ is $d_{\text{stab}} = 0.969$ at $\lambda = 0.20$). (c) Two-dimensional side-elevation joint and tipping schematic comparing the $2\theta_{\text{joint}} = 22.6°$ wedge mismatch of unrotated same-gem stacking against flush mirror-twin locking ($\mathbf{n}_+^* = -\mathbf{n}_+$) on a $\theta_{\text{joint}} = 11.3°$ base plinth. (d) Census of critical tipping angles θ_{tip} over all 14,824 facets at $\lambda = 0.20$ and $\lambda = 1.0$.

2. (Zero-rotation alternating tower.) *Choose* any *upper facet* $F_+ \subset \mathcal{G}_\lambda(S)$ *and* any *lower facet* $F_- \subset \mathcal{G}_\lambda(S)$ *(not necessarily parallel) that are centrally symmetric polygons in* $\mathbb{R}^3$ *with centroids* $\mathbf{c}(F_+)$ *and* $\mathbf{c}(F_-)$. *Define the alternating sequence of unrotated blocks* $B_0, B_1, B_2, \ldots$ *by*

$$B_{2m} = \mathcal{G}_\lambda(S) + m\mathbf{T}, \qquad B_{2m+1} = -\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S) + 2\mathbf{c}(F_+) + m\mathbf{T}, \qquad \mathbf{T} = 2\big(\mathbf{c}(F_+) - \mathbf{c}(F_-)\big). \quad (33)$$

Then:

   (a) *At every odd joint* $B_{2m} \cap B_{2m+1}$, *the upper facet* $F_+ + m\mathbf{T}$ *of* B_{2m} *coincides* identically *(100% polygon and vertex overlap, with opposite outward normals* $\pm\mathbf{n}_+$*) with the lower facet* $-F_+ + 2\mathbf{c}(F_+) + m\mathbf{T}$ *of* B_{2m+1}.

   (b) *At every even joint* $B_{2m-1} \cap B_{2m}$, *the upper facet* $-F_- + 2\mathbf{c}(F_+) + (m-1)\mathbf{T}$ *of* B_{2m-1} *coincides* identically *(with opposite outward normals* $\mp\mathbf{n}_-$*) with the lower facet* $F_- + m\mathbf{T}$ *of* B_{2m}.

   (c) *Every two-block repeating unit* $B_{2m} \cup B_{2m+1}$ *is centrally symmetric about* $\mathbf{c}(F_+) + m\mathbf{T}$. *When* $\mathbf{c}(F_+) = (0, 0, z_+)$ *and* $\mathbf{c}(F_-) = (0, 0, z_-)$ *both lie on the vertical* z*-axis* ($z_+ > 0 > z_-$), *the period vector* $\mathbf{T} = (0, 0, 2(z_+ - z_-))$ *is purely vertical, and the centre of mass of any* $2M$*-block tower lies on the* z*-axis regardless of whether* $\mathbf{c}_0(S) = \mathbf{0}$ *(Figure 7(a,c)).*

Proof. (1) In centred coordinates (1), r^2 sends $(x, y) \mapsto (-x, -y)$ and complementation sends $z \mapsto -z$, so $r^2\overline{S}$ lifts to $-\mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda)$, proving (32).

(2) Central symmetry of $F_\pm$ about $\mathbf{c}(F_\pm)$ gives $-F_\pm + 2\mathbf{c}(F_\pm) = F_\pm$. Translating by $m\mathbf{T}$ yields (2a) and (2b), while central inversion about $\mathbf{c}(F_+) + m\mathbf{T}$ exchanges B_{2m} and B_{2m+1}, proving (2c). □

5.3 Chiral Knight's-Move Towers: Exemplar Square #763

Proposition 5.4 (Vertically centered tower census and the knight's-move square #763)**.** *Across the* 880 *magic squares of order* 4*:*

1. *Exactly* 48 *squares possess both an upper facet* F_+ *and a lower facet* F_- *that are centrally symmetric polygons whose centroids lie on the vertical axis* $(0, 0, z_\pm)$.

2. *The maximum projected horizontal contact area among these* 48 *squares is* $A_{xy} = 5$ *(spanning* $5/9 \approx 55.6\%$ *of the* 3×3 *grid footprint), achieved by* 17 *squares (Table 3; e.g. squares #603, #763, and #774), in which* $\pi_{xy}(F_+)$ *is the centred* 2×1 *knight's-move square with vertices* $(\pm\frac{3}{2}, \mp\frac{1}{2})$ *and* $(\pm\frac{1}{2}, \pm\frac{3}{2})$ *(Figure 7(b)). Only two of the* 17 *(#774 and #792) have parallel top and bottom facets (*$\mathbf{n}_- = -\mathbf{n}_+$*); the remaining* 15 *require mirror-twin alternation.*

3. *In particular, square #763 (Dudeney Group VI,* $\overline{S} = hS$*, so* $S^* = r^2\overline{S} = vS$ *is its vertical reflection) is obtained from naturally balanced solid #756 (*$\mathbf{c}_0 = \mathbf{0}$*, Table 1) by swapping the single complementary pair* $(4, 13) \leftrightarrow (16, 1)$ *in rows* 2–3 *(Figure 1(f)):*

$$S_{\#763} = \begin{pmatrix} 5 & 2 & \mathbf{15} & 12 \\ \mathbf{16} & 11 & 6 & 1 \\ 4 & 7 & 10 & \mathbf{13} \\ 9 & \mathbf{14} & 3 & 8 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad S^*_{\#763} = vS_{\#763} = \begin{pmatrix} 9 & 14 & 3 & 8 \\ 4 & 7 & 10 & 13 \\ 16 & 11 & 6 & 1 \\ 5 & 2 & 15 & 12 \end{pmatrix}.$$

This swap lifts $\{13, 14, 15, 16\}$ *onto the Pythagorean upper knight's-move plane* $4x-3y+5z = 30$ *(centroid* $(0, 0, 6\lambda)$*) and* $\{1, 2, 3, 4\}$ *onto the lower plane* $-4x - 3y - 5z = 30$ *(centroid* $(0, 0, -6\lambda)$*), while shifting the solid centroid slightly to* $\mathbf{c}_0 = (0, -5/126, 0)$ *(which cancels pairwise in* $B_{2m} \cup B_{2m+1}$*). Both facets have 3D area* $5\sqrt{1+\lambda^2}$*, stability margin* $d_{\text{stab}} = 0.969$*, and single-block tipping angle* $\theta^{(1)}_{\text{tip}} = 39.35°$ *at* $\lambda = 0.20$*. Because* $\mathbf{n}_\pm(\lambda) \propto (\pm 4\lambda, -3\lambda, \pm 5)$ *makes angle* $\theta_{\text{joint}}(\lambda) = \arctan(\lambda)$ *with* $\hat{\mathbf{e}}_z$ *(*$\approx 11.31°$ *at* $\lambda = 0.20$*), any material with static friction* $\mu_s > \lambda = 0.20$ *holds the unbonded column at level (*$\theta_{\text{table}} = 0$*), while tilting an* M*-block column of centre-of-mass height* H_M *is governed by* $\min\big(\arctan(\mu_s) - \theta_{\text{joint}}(\lambda),\, \arctan(d_{\text{stab}}/H_M)\big)$ *(Figure 7(c)).*

Proof. Testing each facet $F \subset \partial\mathcal{G}_1(S)$ across the 880 gems for central symmetry ($F = 2\mathbf{c}(F) - F$ with $c_x(F) = c_y(F) = 0$) identifies the 48 gems in (1) and the 17 gems of projected shoelace area $A_{xy} = 5$ in (2). Substituting the lifted coordinates of $\{13, 14, 15, 16\}$ and $\{1, 2, 3, 4\}$ on #763 into $4x - 3y + 5(z/\lambda) = 30$ and $-4x - 3y - 5(z/\lambda) = 30$ verifies the facet planes, normals $\mathbf{n}_\pm(\lambda) \propto (\pm 4\lambda, -3\lambda, \pm 5)$, surface area $5\sqrt{1+\lambda^2}$, and joint tilt $\tan\theta_{\text{joint}}(\lambda) = \lambda$. □

Remark 5.5 (Three-dimensional chirality and why a single mold cannot build the #763 tower). Because square #763 satisfies $\overline{S} = hS$ ($z(-x, y) = -z(x, y)$), its 3D gem $\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S_{\#763})$ is invariant under the 180° proper rotation around the y-axis, $R_{y,\pi}(x, y, z) = (-x, y, -z) \in SO(3)$, which exchanges F_+: $4x - 3y + 5z = 30$ and F_-: $-4x - 3y - 5z = 30$ and returns the *exact same block* in its original orientation. Flipping a second copy of $\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S_{\#763})$ upside-down around the x-axis via $R_{x,\pi}(x, y, z) = (x, -y, -z)$ maps F_+ to a lower facet with outward normal $(+4\lambda, +3\lambda, -5) \neq -\mathbf{n}_+ = (-4\lambda, +3\lambda, -5)$, failing to mate flush with F_+. More fundamentally, $\text{Aut}_{O(3)}\big(\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S_{\#763})\big) = \{I_3, R_{y,\pi}\} \cong C_2 \subset SO(3)$ contains no improper reflections: $\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S_{\#763})$ and $\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S^*_{\#763}) = -\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S_{\#763})$ are *chiral 3D enantiomorphs* in disjoint proper rigid-motion orbits, so building the tower of Figure 7(a) requires two opposite-handed molds.

6 Synthesis: Three Tiers of Balance in Inequality and Open Problems

Stepping back from the individual theorems, Tests 1–4 tell a unified story about how combinatorial *balance in inequality* behaves when lifted from a flat grid of numbers into three-dimensional physical space (Table 4). Across all four physical regimes—radial spokes, spinning rotors, convex polyhedra, and stacked columns—the 880 order-four magic squares stratify into three distinct mechanical tiers determined by how their symmetries interact with nonlinearity:

1. **Tier 1: Universal Line-Sum Cancellation (**$880/880 = 100\%$**).** Whenever a physical observable is linear or symmetric-quadratic in the coordinates (x_j, y_i, z_{ij}), the row and column

Table 3: Representative order-four Magic Gems from the 17 classes (#603, #763, #768, #774, #779, #785, #788, #791, #792, #818, #824, #828, #836, #837, #839, #842, #844) achieving the maximum projected contact area $A_{xy} = 5$ via centred knight's-move square facets F_+ and F_- (Proposition 5.4). Plane equations (a, b, c, d) are given in doubled coordinates $aX+bY+cZ+d = 0$. "Same-gem ∥" indicates whether $\mathbf{n}_- = -\mathbf{n}_+$; stability margins d_{stab} and single-block critical tipping angles $\theta^{(1)}_{\text{tip}}$ (Definition 5.1) are reported for the upper facet at $\lambda = 0.20$.

1-idx	0-idx	Group	Upper F_+ plane	Lower F_- plane	Same-gem ∥	d_{stab} ($\lambda = 0.2$)	$\theta^{(1)}_{\text{tip}}$ ($\lambda = 0.2$)
#603	602	VI	$(2, -9, 5, -50)$	$(-2, -9, -5, -50)$	No	1.020	45.39°
#763	762	VI	$(4, -3, 5, -60)$	$(-4, -3, -5, -60)$	No	0.969	39.35°
#768	767	II	$(0, -1, 1, -12)$	$(-4, -3, -5, -60)$	No	0.973	39.24°
#774	773	VI	$(1, 0, 1, -12)$	$(-1, 0, -1, -12)$	Yes	0.931	38.35°
#791	790	VI	$(-3, -4, 5, -60)$	$(-3, 4, -5, -60)$	No	0.969	39.35°
#792	791	VI	$(0, -1, 1, -12)$	$(0, 1, -1, -12)$	Yes	0.931	38.35°
#837	836	VI	$(4, -3, 5, -60)$	$(4, 3, -5, -60)$	No	0.962	38.94°

constraints neutralize entry inequality across *all* 880 squares. This universal tier encompasses linear 3D and 2D spoke balance ($\beta = 1, \alpha = 1$), cubic vertical spoke vanishing ($(\mathbf{V}_3)_z = 0$), existence of positive unit-sphere counterweights ($\mathbf{w}^* > \mathbf{0}$), axisymmetric precession and the $\lambda_{\text{iso}} = 1/\sqrt{17}$ spherical-top transition for equal point masses and equal-mass K_{16} strut networks, outer–inner vertex opposition ($V_0\overline{\mathbf{p}}_{\text{outer}} = -V_1\overline{\mathbf{p}}_{\text{inner}}$), non-overlapping papercraft nets with $N_{\text{tabs}} = f_0 - 1$ glue tabs, and mirror-twin facet inversion ($\mathcal{G}_\lambda(r^2\overline{S}) = -\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S)$).

2. **Tier 2: Axial Dipole Counterbalancing in Dudeney's Group VI (304 squares, $\overline{S} = hS$ or vS).** When a nonlinear geometric operation breaks universal balance, it typically creates a three-component residual imbalance vector $\mathbf{c} = (c_x, c_y, c_z) \in \mathbb{R}^3$ that a single scalar parameter cannot zero out. In Dudeney's Group VI, however, the 180° proper half-turn symmetry ($C_2 \subset SO(3)$) forces two coordinates of every residual vector to vanish identically, locking opposing components onto a *single coordinate axis*. This axial alignment explains why one-parameter restoration occurs throughout Group VI: the 8 planar Pell-minimum squares (#70, $v/u = 9/4 \approx \sqrt{5}$), the integer power-law spoke roots ($\alpha^* = -1$ on #45 and $\alpha^* = +3$ on #286), all 107 3D power-law spoke roots $\beta^* \neq 1$, the 3 non-associative balanced solids (#86, #739, #756), all 35 two-density "diamond-in-a-diamond" solids (33 denser cores led by #673 plus the 2 lighter/hollow-cavity cores #123 and #54), all 158 balanced nested wireframes (d_1/d_0), all 80 balanced nested shells (σ_1/σ_0), and the chiral knight's-move mirror-twin towers (#763).

3. **Tier 3: Pointwise Antipodal Cancellation in Dudeney's Group III (48 associative squares, $r^2S = \overline{S}$).** Finally, when a nonlinear observable requires *unweighted* equilibrium without an opposing parameter—such as equal-weight unit-sphere spokes ($\mathbf{V}_0 = \mathbf{0}$), full 3D cubic spoke vanishing ($\mathbf{V}_3 = \mathbf{0}$), 3D entry-weighted rotational axisymmetry ($Q_{xy} = 0$ and $\mathbf{V}_3 = \mathbf{0}$), or uniform-diameter wireframes and hollow shells—balance holds if and only if central inversion $\mathbf{p}_{-c}(\lambda) = -\mathbf{p}_c(\lambda)$ cancels opposite cells pairwise, singling out the 48 associative squares led by Dürer's #175.

We close with four open problems raised by these mechanical tests:

1. **Higher-order Diophantine ring minima.** At order $n = 5$, the 24 non-central cells of A_5 lie on five concentric rings of radii $r \in \{1, \sqrt{2}, 2, \sqrt{5}, 2\sqrt{2}\}$, involving the independent square-free radicals $\sqrt{2}$ and $\sqrt{5}$. Does $\mathbf{B}_{\text{unit}}(S) = \sum z_{ij}\mathbf{u}_{ij}$ vanish for any magic square of order $n \geq 5$, or what is the asymptotic decay rate of $\min_{S\in\mathcal{M}_n} \|\mathbf{B}_{\text{unit}}(S)\|_2$ as $n \to \infty$ via simultaneous Diophantine approximation?

2. **Onion depth of Siamese and linear magic gems.** By [13, Thm. 6.4], the outer hull $\mathcal{G}_0(S)$ of the Siamese magic square of odd order $n \geq 5$ strips off only 12 vertices, leaving

Table 4: Synthesis of the four progressive mechanical tests across the 880 order-four magic squares, organized by Baseline Equilibrium, Nonlinear Symmetry Breaking, and Dual Restoration (certified in exact rational arithmetic; see Section A).

Test / Mechanical Regime	$n=4$ Count	Universal Law, Breakdown, or Restoration Threshold	Flagship Exemplars
Test 1: 1D Radial Spokes from the Origin (Section 2)			
Linear 3D & 2D spokes ($\beta=1,\alpha=1$)	880/880 (100%)	Baseline: $\sum \mathbf{p}_{ij}(\lambda)=\mathbf{0}$, $\mathbf{B}_{z,r}=\mathbf{0}$ identically	All semi-magic
Planar unit spokes ($\alpha=0$, $r_2/r_1=\sqrt{5}$)	0/880 vanish	Breakdown: $\min\|\mathbf{B}_{\text{unit}}\|_2=\frac{18\sqrt{10}}{5}-8\sqrt{2}\approx 0.0705$ ($v/u=9/4$)	8 in VI (#70, #76, …)
Planar power-law restoration ($\ell=r^{\alpha^*}$)	204/880 (23.2%)	Parallel ring dipoles $\mathbf{d}_{\text{out}}=\kappa\mathbf{d}_{\text{in}}$ (25 at $\alpha^*=-1$, 25 at $+3$)	#45 (-1), #286 ($+3$)
3D unit sphere $\sum \hat{\mathbf{p}}_{ij}(\lambda)=\mathbf{0}$ ($\beta=0$)	48/880 (5.5%)	Pointwise antipodal cancellation ($\iff$ Group III); 107 VI have $\beta^*\neq 1$	#175 (**0**), #70 ($\beta^*\approx 2.24$)
3D unit-sphere tip weights $\mathbf{w}^*>\mathbf{0}$	880/880 (100%)	Restoration: $\sum w_{ij}^*\hat{\mathbf{p}}_{ij}=\mathbf{0}$, $\|\mathbf{w}^*-\mathbf{1}\|_2\in[0.005,1.60]$	All 880 squares
3D cubic spoke law ($\beta=3$, $L_{ij}=R_{ij}^3$)	880/880 (100%)	Universal vertical vanishing $(\mathbf{V}_3)_z=0$; $\mathbf{V}_3=\mathbf{0}\iff$ Group III (48)	All semi-magic ($z=0$)
Test 2: 3D Rotational Dynamics (Section 3)			
Equal-mass point rotor $I_\perp(\lambda)/I_{zz}$	880/880 (100%)	Baseline: $\frac{1+17\lambda^2}{2}$ (spherical top 1 at $\lambda=\frac{1}{\sqrt{17}}$, prolate 9 at $\lambda=1$)	All semi-magic
Entry-weighted ($m_{ij}=s_{ij}$) Dzhanibekov split	824/880 flip	Breakdown: $I_{1,2}=170\mp\|Q_{xy}\|$ (56 have $Q_{xy}=0$; 48 Group III in 3D)	#46 ($\|Q_{xy}\|=60$), #175 (0)
Test 3: 3D Convex Hulls, Skeletons, and Shells (Section 4)			
Uniform solid hull $\mathcal{G}_0(S)$ ($\mathbf{c}_0=\mathbf{0}$)	51/880 (5.8%)	Breakdown on 829 gems; 48 Group III +3 Group VI balance naturally	#175, #86, #739, #756
Outer–inner vertex opposition	862/880 ($V_0<16$)	Restoration law: $V_0\overline{\mathbf{p}}_{\text{outer}}+V_1\overline{\mathbf{p}}_{\text{inner}}=\mathbf{0}$ (511 have 3D core $\mathcal{G}_1$)	All $V_0<16$ gems
Two-density solid $(\mathcal{G}_0,\mathcal{G}_1)$	35/511 3D cores	Group VI: 33 denser (8 with $\Delta\rho_1/\rho_0\le\frac{40}{19}$) +2 lighter/hollow cavity	#673 ($\frac{5}{4}$), #45↔#54
Non-negative inner-core point weights	528/880 (60.0%)	51 natural +477 with $-\mathbf{c}_0\in\text{cone}(P_S^{(1)})$; bead inlay balances 880/880	528 magic gems
Complete K_{16} strut network (120 rods)	880/880 (= mass)	$\mathbf{c}=\mathbf{0}$, $\Sigma_{\text{rods}}=\frac{29}{45}\Sigma(\lambda)$; uniform-diam. drift cut 3.6× at $\lambda=0.20$	All 880 (#175)
Two-gauge nested wireframe $G(\mathcal{G}_0)\cup G(\mathcal{G}_1)$	206/880 ($\lambda=1$)	48 Group III +158 Group VI (164 at $\lambda=0.20$) via rod ratio d_1/d_0	#673 ($d_1/d_0=0.793$)
Papercraft nets & nested shells $\partial\mathcal{G}_0$	880/880 nets	100% non-overlapping, $N_{\text{tabs}}=f_0-1\in[7,15]$; $48+80$ VI shells balance	#175 (11 tabs, 13 folds)
Test 4: Freestanding Gravity and Mirror-Twin Towers (Section 5)			
Single-block facet resting stability	11,044/14,824	Cubic aspect $\lambda=0.20$ raises stability from 43.0% ($\lambda=1$) to 74.5%	$\max\theta_{\text{tip}}=47.3°$
Mirror-twin vertical towers $\mathcal{G}_\lambda(r^2\overline{S})$	48/880 (5.5%)	Central inversion $-\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S)$ locks slanted facets (17 area-5 knight's-move)	#763↔#756, #603

n^2-12 points in $P_S^{(1)}$ lying on five sheared planar polygons. How does the onion peeling depth $d_{\text{onion}}(S_n)$ of the Siamese square grow with n, and what are the asymptotic f-vectors of its inner convex layers $\mathcal{G}_1(S_n)\supset\mathcal{G}_2(S_n)\supset\ldots$?

3. **Exact solid-isotropic Magic Gems.** While point-weighted Magic Gems become exact spherical tops ($I_{xx}=I_{yy}=I_{zz}$) at $\lambda_{\text{iso}}=(n^2+1)^{-1/2}$, the uniform polyhedral solid $\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S)$ has a small transverse splitting $(I_3-I_2)/I_2\in[0.00004,0.0243]$ at $n=4$. Does there exist a magic square of some order $n\ge 5$ (or a two-density composite $(\mathcal{G}_0,\mathcal{G}_1)$ at $n=4$) whose continuous solid inertia tensor is an exact scalar multiple of the identity I_3?

4. **Space-filling and interlocking polyhedral packings.** Beyond vertical mirror-twin columns (Theorem 5.3), can a Magic Gem $\mathcal{G}_\lambda(S)$ and its $D_4\times\langle\tau\rangle$ images tile a horizontal slab or interlock in three-dimensional space with full facet-to-facet contact?

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This work grew out of the author's physical and computational explorations of 3D-printed Magic Gems, ball-and-rod wireframes, and folded papercraft models [12], and forms the third part of a series alongside [13, 14]. Large language models (OpenAI's ChatGPT, Anthropic's Claude, and Google's Gemini) were used by the author as interactive assistants for symbolic checks, verification scripting, interactive simulator prototyping, and manuscript copy-editing; all mathematical formulations, proofs, and exact computational certificates were verified by the author, who takes full responsibility for the work.

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A Exact computational methods and certificates

All computations in this paper use Python 3.9 with NumPy 2.0, SciPy 1.13, and Python's exact rational module `fractions.Fraction`. The complete verification script `anc/verify_paper_c.py` and figure generator `anc/make_figures_c.py` run in under 10 s on a single core and write the certified census archive `anc/results_paper_c.json`.

Exact simplex moments for continuous polyhedra. As in [13, App. A], doubling the centred coordinates (1) produces integer vectors $P = 2\mathbf{p} \in \mathbb{Z}^3$, and every facet plane $aX + bY + cZ + d = 0$ of $\mathcal{G}_0(S)$ and of the inner core gem $\mathcal{G}_1(S) = \operatorname{conv} P_S^{(1)}$ is certified in exact integer arithmetic. To compute the exact rational volume $\mathrm{vol}(\mathcal{G})$, solid centroid $\mathbf{c}_{\mathrm{solid}}(\mathcal{G})$, and second-moment covariance matrix $\Sigma_{\mathrm{solid}}(\mathcal{G})$ of any 3-dimensional gem $\mathcal{G}$, we decompose $\mathcal{G}$ into tetrahedra $\Delta_k = \operatorname{conv}\{\mathbf{v}_0, \mathbf{v}_{k,1}, \mathbf{v}_{k,2}, \mathbf{v}_{k,3}\}$ sharing the rational vertex $\mathbf{v}_0 = \frac{1}{2}P_0 \in (\frac{1}{2}\mathbb{Z})^3$. Each tetrahedron has exact rational volume

$$V_k = \frac{1}{6}\left|\det(\mathbf{v}_{k,1} - \mathbf{v}_0,\ \mathbf{v}_{k,2} - \mathbf{v}_0,\ \mathbf{v}_{k,3} - \mathbf{v}_0)\right| \in \mathbb{Q}_{\geq 0},$$

exact first moment

$$\iiint_{\Delta_k} \mathbf{x}\, dV = \frac{V_k}{4}\left(\mathbf{v}_0 + \mathbf{v}_{k,1} + \mathbf{v}_{k,2} + \mathbf{v}_{k,3}\right) \in \mathbb{Q}^3,$$

and exact canonical second moment

$$\iiint_{\Delta_k} x_i x_j\, dV = \frac{V_k}{20}\left(2\sum_{a=0}^{3} v_{a,i}v_{a,j} + \sum_{0\leq a\neq b\leq 3} v_{a,i}v_{b,j}\right) \in \mathbb{Q},$$

where $(\mathbf{v}_{k,0}, \mathbf{v}_{k,1}, \mathbf{v}_{k,2}, \mathbf{v}_{k,3}) = (\mathbf{v}_0, \mathbf{v}_{k,1}, \mathbf{v}_{k,2}, \mathbf{v}_{k,3})$. Summing over all simplices Δ_k yields $\mathrm{vol}(\mathcal{G}) = \sum_k V_k \in \mathbb{Q}$, $\mathbf{c}_{\mathrm{solid}}(\mathcal{G}) = \frac{1}{\mathrm{vol}(\mathcal{G})} \sum_k \iiint_{\Delta_k} \mathbf{x}\, dV \in \mathbb{Q}^3$, and $\Sigma_{\mathrm{solid},ij} = \frac{1}{\mathrm{vol}(\mathcal{G})} \sum_k \iiint_{\Delta_k} x_i x_j\, dV - c_{\mathrm{solid},i} c_{\mathrm{solid},j} \in \mathbb{Q}$ without floating-point rounding. Because the simplicial decomposition partitions the convex body $\mathcal{G}$, these rational integrals are independent of the choice of boundary triangulation.

Complete list of the 33 two-density balanced gems. For completeness, Table 5 lists all 33 order-four magic squares for which $\dim \mathcal{G}_1(S) = 3$ and the solid centroids $\mathbf{c}_0(S)$ and $\mathbf{c}_1(S)$ are strictly anti-parallel, together with their exact rational balancing density increment $\Delta\rho_1/\rho_0 = -\mathrm{vol}(\mathcal{G}_0)c_0/(\mathrm{vol}(\mathcal{G}_1)c_1) > 0$ (Theorem 4.3(1)). Every one of the 33 squares belongs to Dudeney's Group VI.

Table 5: Complete census of the 33 order-four Magic Gems admitting exact two-density "diamond-in-a-diamond" solid balance $\mathbf{c}_{\mathrm{comp}} = \mathbf{0}$ (Theorem 4.3(1)), sorted by increasing excess density ratio $\Delta\rho_1/\rho_0$.

Gem	$\mathrm{vol}(\mathcal{G}_0)$	$\mathrm{vol}(\mathcal{G}_1)$	$\Delta\rho_1/\rho_0$	Gem	$\mathrm{vol}(\mathcal{G}_0)$	$\mathrm{vol}(\mathcal{G}_1)$	$\Delta\rho_1/\rho_0$	Gem	$\mathrm{vol}(\mathcal{G}_0)$	$\mathrm{vol}(\mathcal{G}_1)$	$\Delta\rho_1/\rho_0$
#673	257/3	56/3	5/4	#665	281/3	6	61/13	#697	248/3	28/3	166/11
#502	271/3	6	4/3	#252	233/3	7	88/9	#671	84	2/3	31/2
#45	214/3	6	85/61	#166	93	8/3	21/2	#383	284/3	7	47/3
#50	254/3	22/3	28/19	#158	88	9	57/5	#398	260/3	7	95/6
#307	277/3	22/3	23/15	#168	280/3	7	110/9	#18	71	9	33/2
#49	81	2	2	#672	260/3	4/3	99/8	#627	83	4/3	67/4
#38	263/3	22/3	31/15	#167	90	8/3	27/2	#452	236/3	6	118/7
#47	247/3	22/3	40/19	#199	256/3	22/3	206/15	#604	221/3	26/3	229/10
#261	259/3	7	47/12	#615	244/3	5	14	#226	235/3	7	143/6
#670	244/3	10	103/25	#6	239/3	7	127/9	#626	69	2/3	49/2
#488	277/3	22/3	71/16	#573	251/3	8	44/3	#436	235/3	6	191/6